The Knowledge Gap Among Bangladesh Army Officers on the Functional Understanding of Civil Administration: An Assessment to Enhance Performance in Aid to Civil Power Duties

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Declaration

I hereby declare that the Individual Research Paper titled "The Knowledge Gap Among Bangladesh Army Officers on the Functional Understanding of Civil Administration: An Assessment to Enhance Performance in Aid to Civil Power Duties", submitted for the DSCSC 2026 Course, is my original work. This work has not formed the basis for the award of any degree, associateship, fellowship or any other similar title.

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Abstract

Bangladesh Army has seven stated roles, of which three involve assisting the civil administration at home. Officers of the Army have therefore exercised the powers of civil administrators and police in various national emergencies. Yet no written, curricular or institutional training or test of the civil administration knowledge these duties demand has existed. This study assessed whether officers' knowledge is adequate for these duties and how any shortfall affects their performance. It followed a mixed-method design. First, the researcher identified the standard in six knowledge domains through a study of the Constitution and governing laws. A survey of 360 officers, eight interviews with senior commanders and civil officials, and two focus group discussions then re-evaluated that standard through different tiers of officers. The primary data were analysed through frequencies, mean scores, group comparisons and thematic analysis. By evaluating their own performance, officers stated what they need to know and how much they know, based on the ground realities of the prolonged and challenging deployment of 2024.

Through the performance indicators and assessments, officers were found to fall short of the functional knowledge these duties require, particularly in human rights compliance, magistracy procedure and legal procedures. Knowledge did not improve with rank, service or deployments. Officers with limited knowledge met hesitation, documentation errors, over-reliance on magistrates and friction with civil officials 32 to 36 percentage points more often than better-informed officers. Further analysis pointed to six institutional factors that sustain the gap in a cycle, which shows that the gap is institutional rather than individual. The study therefore recommends a career-long knowledge pathway, an examined module, revised doctrine, field legal support, joint training with civil agencies and a field exercise before such duties are performed.

Keywords: aid to civil administration, civil administration knowledge, knowledge gap, magistracy powers, military training, Bangladesh Army

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List of Abbreviations

AHQ	Army Headquarters
ARTDOC	Army Training and Doctrine Command
BMA	Bangladesh Military Academy
BPATC	Bangladesh Public Administration Training Centre
CrPC	Code of Criminal Procedure, 1898
DC	Deputy Commissioner and District Magistrate
DSCSC	Defence Services Command and Staff College
FGD	Focus group discussion
H0	Null hypothesis
H1	Alternative hypothesis
JAG	Judge Advocate General's department
M	Mean
MOOTW	Military operations other than war
n, *N*	Number of respondents in a group, in the whole sample
NCO	Non-commissioned officer
NDC	National Defence College
SEM	Special Executive Magistrate; Special Executive Magistracy
SI&T	School of Infantry and Tactics
SOP	Standing operating procedure
SP	Superintendent of Police
UNO	Upazila Nirbahi Officer

The Knowledge Gap Among Bangladesh Army Officers on the Functional Understanding of Civil Administration: An Assessment to Enhance Performance in Aid to Civil Power Duties

Chapter I
Introduction

Background

Bangladesh Army has been employed in aid to civil power on many occasions since independence. It supported the nation after the cyclone of 1991 (Smith, 1995), after Cyclone Sidr in 2007 (United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs, 2007), during the Rohingya influx of 2017 (VOA News, 2017) and during the COVID-19 pandemic (Armed Forces Division, n.d.; Press Trust of India, 2020). It has also aided the civil administration in restoring law and order and during national events (Bangladesh Army, n.d.-b). Such employment has not always been free of legal controversy. Operation Clean Heart in 2002 led to mass arrests and deaths in detention (World Organisation Against Torture, 2002), and the High Court later declared the indemnity law that protected it illegal (BBC News Bangla, 2015). In every such employment, the Army works under the authority of the civil administration (Bangladesh Army, n.d.-a). Officers, therefore, must understand how the civil administration functions.

The nature of these duties changed sharply in 2024. During the July uprising, the government imposed a curfew and deployed the Army (Al Jazeera, 2024). Routine policing then collapsed across the country. On 17 September 2024, the Ministry of Public Administration gave commissioned Army officers "the powers of an Executive Magistrate" under Sections 12(1) and 17 of the Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC), 1898 (The Business Standard, 2024a; The Daily Star, 2024a). The order allowed officers to act under 17 provisions of the Code. These cover arrest, execution of warrants, search, security proceedings, dispersal of unlawful assemblies, use of armed force in dispersal and removal of public nuisance (The Daily Star, 2024c). The same powers were later extended to the Navy and the Air Force (bdnews24.com, 2024).

The order was first given for 60 days. It was renewed in November 2024 and through 2025, and the last nationwide renewal ran until 28 February 2026 (The Daily Star, 2025). During this period, troops recovered looted weapons (Sarkar, 2024; United News of Bangladesh, 2026a) and carried out joint raids with other agencies (The Business Standard, 2024c). For the national election of 12 February 2026, the Army deployed about 100,000 troops to 544 camps (The Business Standard, 2026). The Army was to return to barracks once the new government took oath (United News of Bangladesh, 2026b). Even so, the powers were restored from 22 to 30 June 2026 in three metropolitan areas and three districts (Biswas, 2026; The Financial Express, 2026).

In these deployments, Army officers exercised magisterial power more directly than ever before. Police and civil administration officers are formally trained before they use such powers (Bangladesh Civil Service Administration Academy, n.d.; Rtv News, 2024). Army officers used the same powers without institutional training, a written standard or any test. This difference between the authority given and the knowledge provided forms the background of this study.

The Army calls these duties aid to civil power, while the 2024 order deployed troops in aid to civil administration. In this paper both terms refer to the same duties. The term aid to civil administration is used hereafter, as it matches the legal order under which the powers were given.

Statement of the Problem

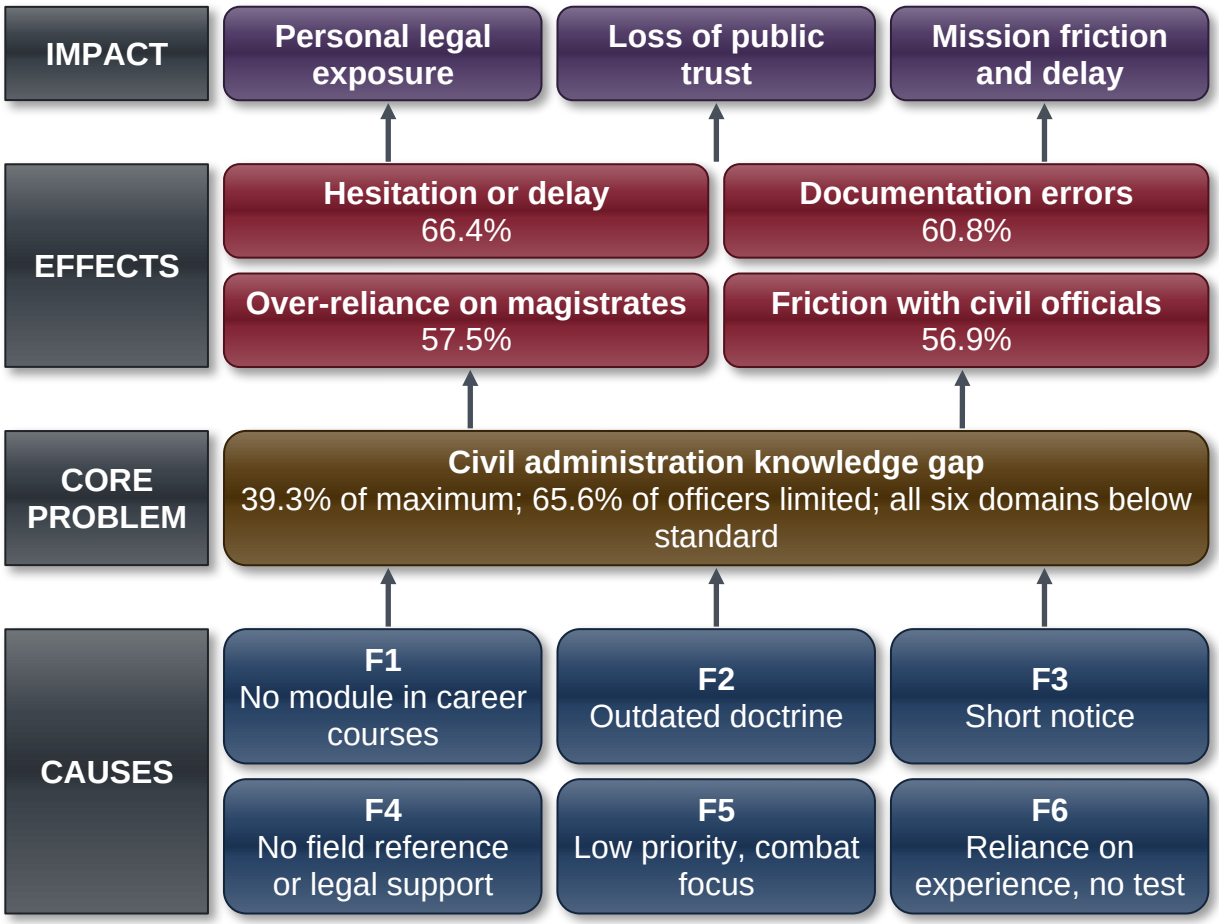
Aid to civil administration is one of the specified roles of Bangladesh Army (Bangladesh Army, n.d.-a). The role demands knowledge of civil law, magistracy procedure, inter-agency coordination, human rights, crowd management and communication with civil authorities. These subjects remain largely outside military training. When the powers were given, the national press warned that the Army must guard against their misuse (The Daily Star, 2024b), and political leaders asked that they be used only where necessary (The Business Standard, 2024b). A study of United States military training reports a similar pattern, as military curricula give limited weight to civil tasks and their legal framework (Reed et al., 2020).

Army officers thus exercised magisterial and law-enforcement powers without a defined standard of knowledge, structured training or assessment. Neither the size of the resulting knowledge gap nor its effect on performance has been measured. This

study sets out to measure the gap, to explain why it exists and to suggest how it can be reduced (Figure 1.1).

Figure 1.1

Problem Tree of the Civil Administration Knowledge Gap



Note. Researcher's own construct from Chapters III and IV. Effects are the share of officers meeting each problem often or always.

Review of Literature

The review covered books, journal articles, doctrine, statutes, government notifications and press reports. It examined four questions: the limits of military involvement in civil functions, the knowledge such work requires, the practice of comparable forces, and the Bangladesh context. Table 1.1 summarises the main findings.

Huntington (1957) argued that the military is most effective when it specialises in the management of violence and civilian institutions keep administrative functions. Janowitz (1960) accepted a wider role. His constabulary model holds that modern forces must build social and administrative competence for internal security tasks. The

two writers differ on the role itself, but they agree on one point. Officers must hold the relevant knowledge before they take up a civil role.

Becker (1964) treats training as an investment that produces measurable returns in output. A role assigned without such investment will therefore produce lower returns.

Spencer and Spencer (1993) separate the visible layer of competence, namely knowledge and skill, from deeper traits and motives. The visible layer can be defined, trained and tested.

In Bangladesh, Hassan et al. (2026) examined the Law and Administration Course of the civil service against workplace competencies. The civil service thus already treats legal and administrative knowledge as something to be taught and checked.

Croissant et al. (2013) treated internal security as a test of civilian control in new Asian democracies, including Bangladesh. Reed et al. (2020) found that United States military doctrine and training give limited attention to the competencies needed for humanitarian and disaster relief tasks. Ries (2022) reviewed 45 publications from 22 countries and identified clear frameworks and joint civil-military exercises as common features of effective coordination. The deficit these studies describe is institutional and not a matter of individual ability.

Ahamed (1988) explains that the Army inherited a custodian-of-order outlook from its British Indian and Pakistani predecessors.

Sahoo and Vishwanathan (2023) trace the move of Bangladesh from military dominance towards civilian control. These studies analyse institutions and regimes. None of them measures the knowledge of the officers who exercise civil authority. The Constitution, the CrPC and the Penal Code state the provisions an officer must know before acting (Code of Criminal Procedure, 1898; Constitution of the People's Republic of Bangladesh, 1972; Penal Code, 1860). The two volumes of Army doctrine on military operations other than war (MOOTW), however, do not cover the legal, magisterial or coordination domains (Army Training and Doctrine Command [ARTDOC], 2016a, 2016b). The doctrine was written before the powers were delegated and does not address them.

Analysis of the Literature

The literature points in one direction from four separate angles. Theory warns that a civil role without civil knowledge carries risk. The law defines the knowledge the role demands, while Army doctrine largely omits it. Studies of other forces trace the deficit to training and doctrine rather than to individuals. Each source therefore reaches the same condition: officers must hold the knowledge before they exercise the authority. The delegation of September 2024 tested this condition at national scale. Any gap is thus likely to be organisational rather than individual. It also follows that the required knowledge can be set from the law and from field practice, and then measured.

Table 1.1

Literature Concept Matrix

Source	Civil-military boundary	Knowledge and competence	Training and doctrine	Joint coordination	Bangladesh context	Measures officers' knowledge
Huntington (1957)	●	○				
Janowitz (1960)	●	●	○	○		
Becker (1964)		●	●			
Spencer and Spencer (1993)		●	○			
Ahamed (1988)	●				●	
Croissant et al. (2013)	●			○	○	
Reed et al. (2020)		●	●			
Ries (2022)			○	●		
Sahoo and Vishwanathan (2023)	●				●	
Hassan et al. (2026)		●	●		●	
ARTDOC (2016a, 2016b)			●	○	●	
CrPC, Constitution, Penal Code		●			●	
This study (2026)	●	●	●	●	●	●

Note. Researcher's coding of the sources. ● = main theme; ○ = treated in part; blank = not addressed.

Research Gap

No study has defined the civil administration knowledge an Army officer needs for these duties, measured what officers actually hold, or linked the shortfall to performance on the ground. This study addresses that gap.

Theoretical Framework

A theoretical framework allows an issue to be examined under the lens of a theory. In this case, it helps to explain why a gap may exist, how it can be measured and what actions might close it. This study uses four theories to explain, assess and evaluate officers' knowledge. Figure 1.2 shows how they connect and where each is used, and Table 1.2 traces each from concept to indicator.

Theories of the Military Role

Huntington's (1957) theory of objective civilian control has two concepts: professional specialisation and a clear boundary between military and civil functions. It says that the military crosses that boundary if it works in a field in which it is not trained. The theory therefore treats a civil role without civil knowledge as a risk to the task and to the institution. Janowitz's (1960) constabulary concept accepts that modern forces will have to perform internal security tasks. Its key idea is that such forces must be trained on such functions. The two theories conflict on whether the military should take up the role. However, they agree on the condition of attaining knowledge prior to performing it. This condition forms the first proposition of the study: knowledge must come before authority (P1).

Theories of Knowledge

Becker's (1964) human capital theory treats knowledge as the product of deliberate investment in training. Where an organisation assigns a task but does not invest in the related training, knowledge stays low and output falls. This gives the second proposition of the study: without institutional training, a gap persists regardless of rank or experience (P2). Spencer and Spencer's (1993) competency model divides competence into visible layers, knowledge and skill, and hidden layers, such as motive and trait. The visible layers can be compared to the standard, taught and tested. This gives the third proposition: the gap can be defined, measured and reduced or nullified (P3).

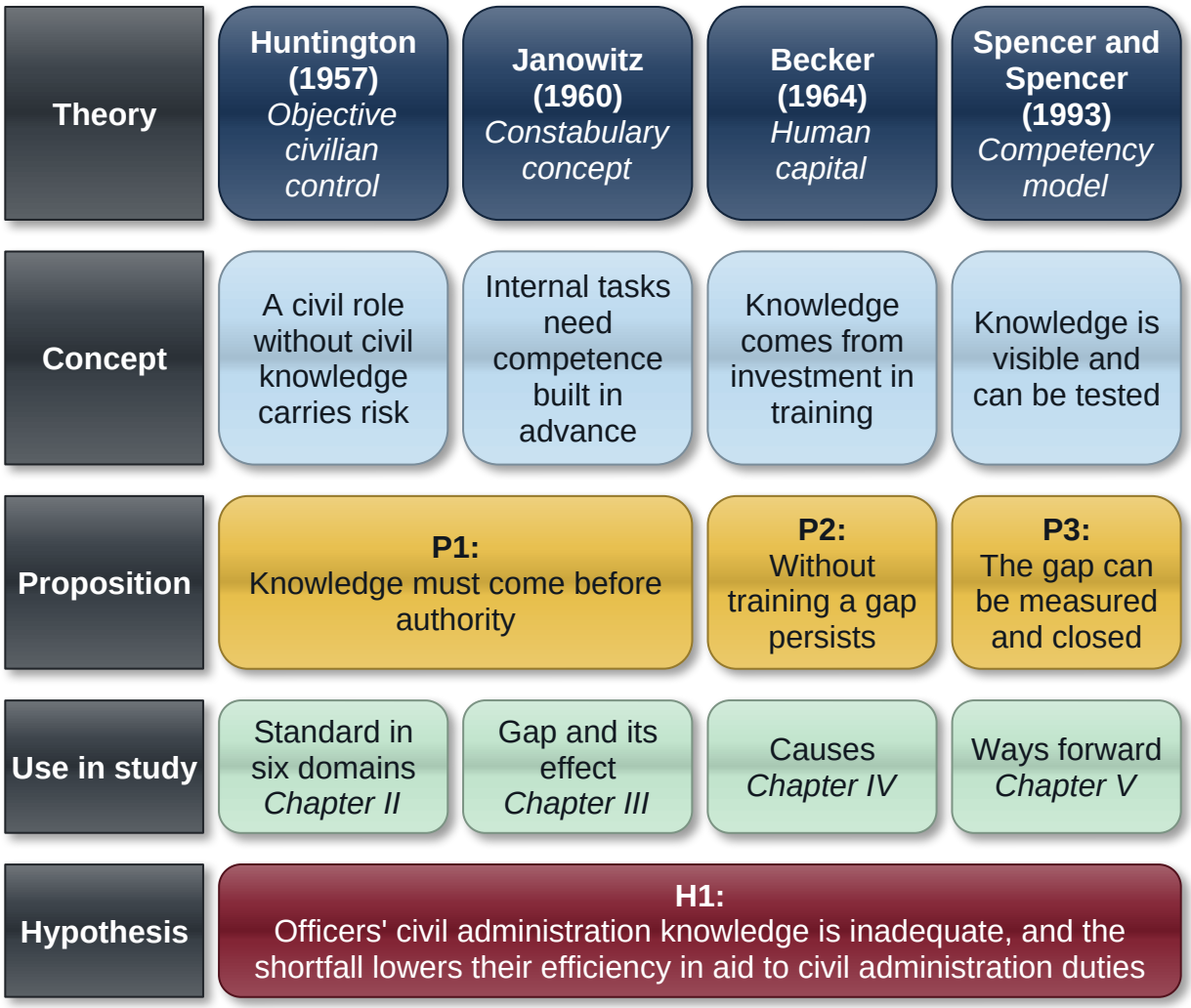
Correlation Among the Theories

The four theories form a complete cycle of reasoning. Initially, the theories set the condition that knowledge must come before authority. Human capital theory explains why the condition may not be met, namely the absence of investment in training. The competency model makes the condition measurable through a written standard and a test. Together they predict that officers given civil powers without

training will show a measurable gap, and that the gap will lower their performance. This prediction is the hypothesis of the study.

Figure 1.2

Theoretical Framework of the Study



Note. Researcher's own construct based on Huntington (1957), Janowitz (1960), Becker (1964) and Spencer and Spencer (1993). P = proposition; H1 = alternative hypothesis.

How the Framework Guides the Analysis

The framework helps the research at each stage. First, P1 and the competency model justify building a written standard of knowledge in six domains (Chapter II). Second, P3 allows the gap to be measured as the distance between that standard and officers' own ratings, and its effect to be read through four problems on the ground (Chapter III). Third, P2 and human capital theory direct the search for causes towards training, doctrine and assessment rather than towards individual failings (Chapter IV).

If the theory holds, experience alone will not close the gap, and Chapter III tests exactly this point. Finally, the same logic shapes the ways forward, which call for investment in training and a test before authority (Chapter V).

Table 1.2

Operationalisation Matrix: From Theory to Indicator

Theory	Key concept	Proposition	Variable	Indicator used	Tested in
Huntington (1957)	Specialisation and boundary	P1: knowledge before authority	Independent: knowledge in six domains	Nine knowledge items, six-point scale	Ch II, III
Janowitz (1960)	Competence built in advance	P1: knowledge before authority	Independent: knowledge in six domains	Domain importance; expert views	Ch II
Becker (1964)	Investment in training	P2: without training a gap persists	Factors F1 to F6; training, rank, service	Course coverage; factor agreement	Ch III, IV
Spencer and Spencer (1993)	Visible, testable competence	P3: gap can be measured and closed	Gap; dependent: four problems	Gap in points; frequency of problems	Ch III, V

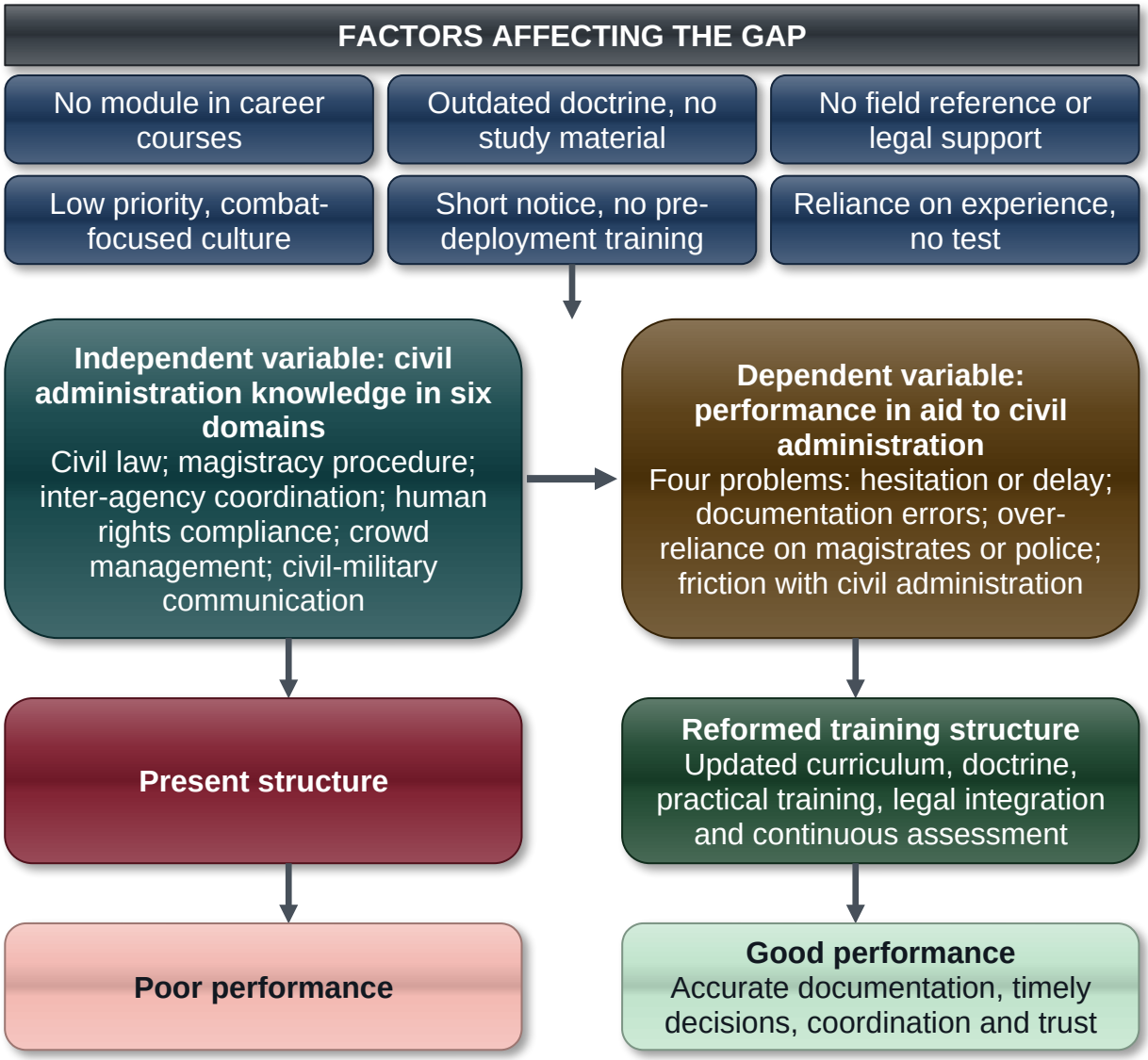
Note. Researcher's own construct. P = proposition (Chapter I).

Conceptual Framework

The conceptual framework turns the theory into variables that can be observed clearly (Figure 1.3). The independent variable is officers' civil administration knowledge in six domains: civil law, magistracy procedure, inter-agency coordination, human rights compliance, crowd management and civil-military communication. The domains come from the law and are set in Chapter II. The dependent variable is performance in aid to civil administration duties. It is read through four problems that officers meet on the ground: hesitation or delay, documentation errors, over-reliance on magistrates or police, and friction with the civil administration. Fewer problems mean better performance.

Figure 1.3

Conceptual Framework: Factors, Knowledge Domains and Performance



Note. Researcher's own construct based on the theoretical framework in Figure 1.2. Each factor may affect more than one domain.

Aim of the Research

The aim of this study is to assess the nature and extent of the civil administration knowledge gap among officers of Bangladesh Army and its effect on performance in aid to civil administration duties, in order to recommend measures to reduce it.

Research Objectives

Broad Objective

To assess the nature and extent of the knowledge gap among Bangladesh Army officers on the functional understanding of civil administration, in order to perform aid to civil administration duties efficiently.

Specific Objectives

1. To determine the knowledge an officer requires to perform aid to civil administration duties, and how that knowledge affects performance during deployment.
2. To measure the present state of civil administration knowledge among officers from lieutenant to lieutenant colonel with experience of these duties.
3. To determine the gap between existing and required knowledge.
4. To identify the factors that contribute to the gap.
5. To recommend measures to enhance officers' knowledge for aid to civil administration duties.

Research Questions

Primary Question

Is the present civil administration knowledge of Bangladesh Army officers adequate to perform aid to civil administration duties effectively?

Secondary Questions

1. What knowledge does an officer require to perform aid to civil administration duties, and how does it affect performance while deployed?
2. What is the existing state of knowledge among officers, and what is the gap with the required knowledge?
3. What factors affect the knowledge gap among officers?
4. What measures are recommended to enhance knowledge and reduce the gap?

Table 1.3 links each question with its objective, method and chapter.

Table 1.3

Research Questions, Objectives, Methods and Chapters

Research question	Objective	Method	Chapter
Primary: Is present knowledge adequate to perform aid to civil administration duties effectively?	Broad	Mixed methods (quantitative and qualitative)	III and V
1. What knowledge is required, and how does it affect performance while deployed?	1	Document study; interviews	II
2. What is the existing state of knowledge, and what is the gap with the required knowledge?	2 and 3	Survey; interviews; FGDs	III
3. What factors affect the knowledge gap?	4	Survey; interviews; FGDs; comparison with other institutions	IV
4. What measures are recommended to enhance knowledge and reduce the gap?	5	All sources; comparison with other institutions	V

Note. Researcher's own construct. Objectives are numbered as in the list of specific objectives. FGD = focus group discussion.

Hypothesis

Alternative Hypothesis (H1)

The civil administration knowledge of Bangladesh Army officers is inadequate, and this inadequacy lowers their efficiency in aid to civil administration duties.

Null Hypothesis (H0)

The civil administration knowledge of Bangladesh Army officers is adequate, or any shortfall has no significant effect on their efficiency in aid to civil administration duties.

Research Variables

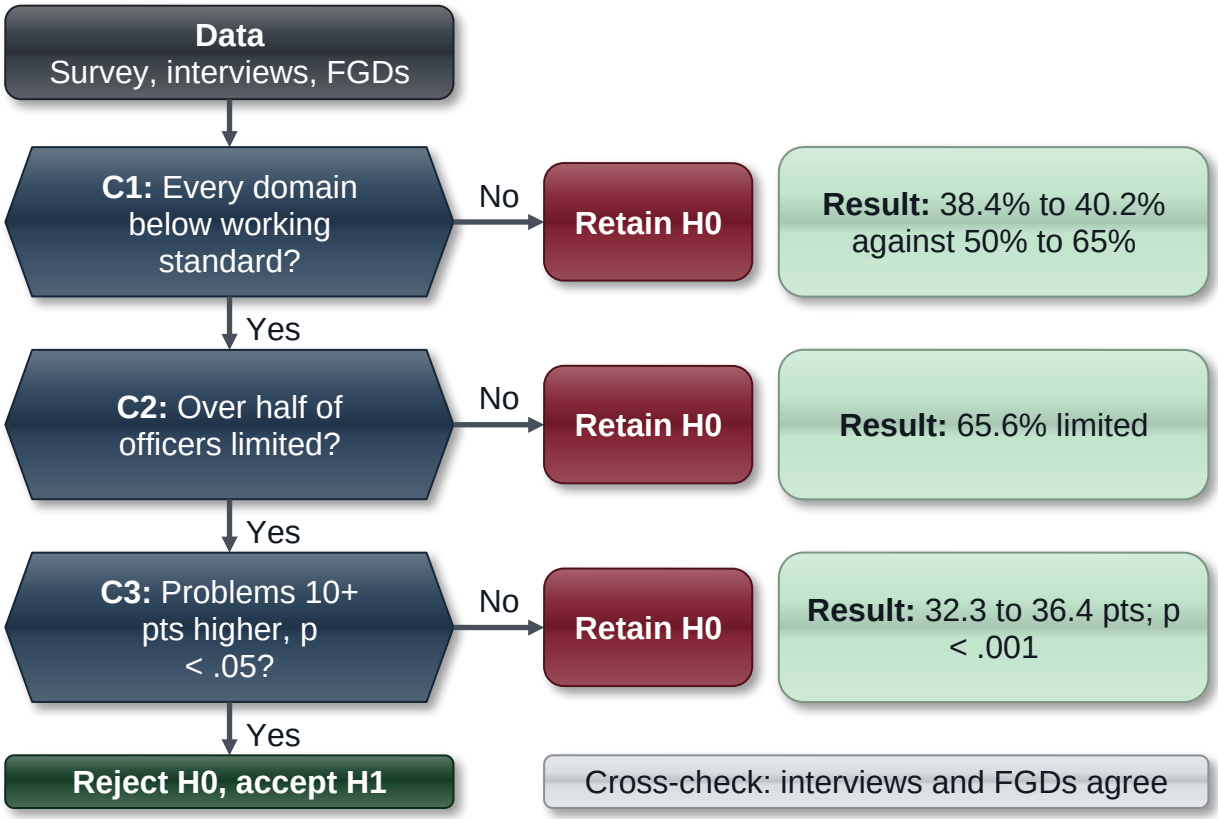
The independent variable is officers' civil administration knowledge in the six domains. The dependent variable is their efficiency in aid to civil administration duties, measured by how often they meet the four problems shown in Figure 1.3.

How and Where the Hypothesis Is Tested

The hypothesis is tested in Chapter III against a decision rule fixed in advance (Figure 1.4). H0 is rejected only if three conditions are met. First, mean knowledge must fall below the working standard of Chapter II in every domain. Second, more than half of the officers must have limited knowledge. Third, officers with limited knowledge must meet each of the four problems at least 10 percentage points more often than better-informed officers, and each difference must be statistically significant in a two-proportion z-test ($p < .05$). The first two conditions test inadequacy, and the third tests the effect on efficiency. The survey result is then checked against the interviews and FGDs, so that the decision does not rest on one source. The decision is made in Chapter III (Table 3.5) and carried into the conclusions in Chapter V.

Figure 1.4

Hypothesis Decision Tree



Note. Researcher's own construct. Results are from Chapter III and Annexure B.

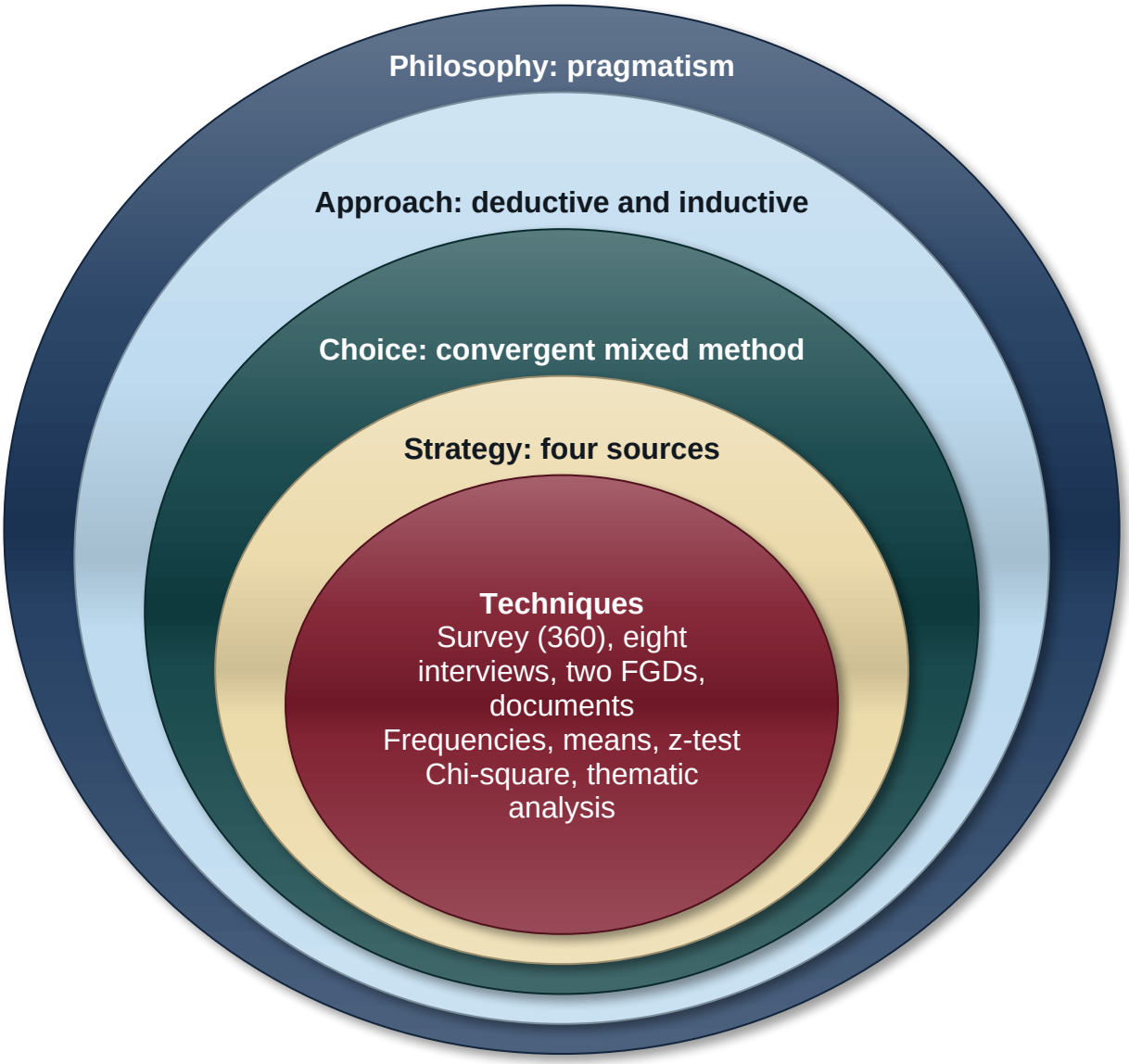
Research Methodology

Research Design

The study used a mixed-method design (Creswell & Creswell, 2018; Figure 1.5). Document study set the standard of knowledge. A survey measured the gap and its effect. Interviews and focus group discussions (FGDs) explained the causes and tested whether the survey results held.

Figure 1.5

Research Design Layers



Note. Adapted from the layered research design model; content is the researcher's own design.

Population and Sample

The population comprised about 1,000 officers up to the rank of lieutenant colonel with experience in aid to civil administration. Cochran's (1977) formula, corrected for this population, required 278 responses for a 5% margin of error at 95% confidence (Annexure B). The survey received 360 valid responses, which gives a margin of error of 4.1%. Participation was voluntary, so the sample is not strictly random.

Data Collection

The survey was run on Google Forms from 17 to 31 July 2026 (Annexure A). Eight interviews were held in July 2026. Six were with senior commanders and directors of Army Headquarters and formations, and two were with the Deputy Commissioner and District Magistrate (DC) and the Superintendent of Police (SP) of Sylhet (Annexure D). Two FGDs were held, one with four junior officers at the Defence Services Command and Staff College (DSCSC) and one with the command group of an infantry battalion (Annexure E). Laws, notifications, doctrine and press reports formed the documentary data. Table 1.4 lists the sources.

Table 1.4

Sources of Data

Source	Respondents or material	Used for
Document study	Laws, notifications, doctrine, press reports and training records	Standard and comparisons (Chapter II)
Survey	*N* = 360 officers, lieutenant to lieutenant colonel, with experience in aid to civil administration	Knowledge, gap and effect (Chapter III); causes and measures (Chapters IV and V)
Interviews	Six senior commanders and directors; the DC and SP of Sylhet	Standard, effects, causes and measures

Source	Respondents or material	Used for
Focus group discussions	Four junior officers; the command group of an infantry battalion	Effects and causes

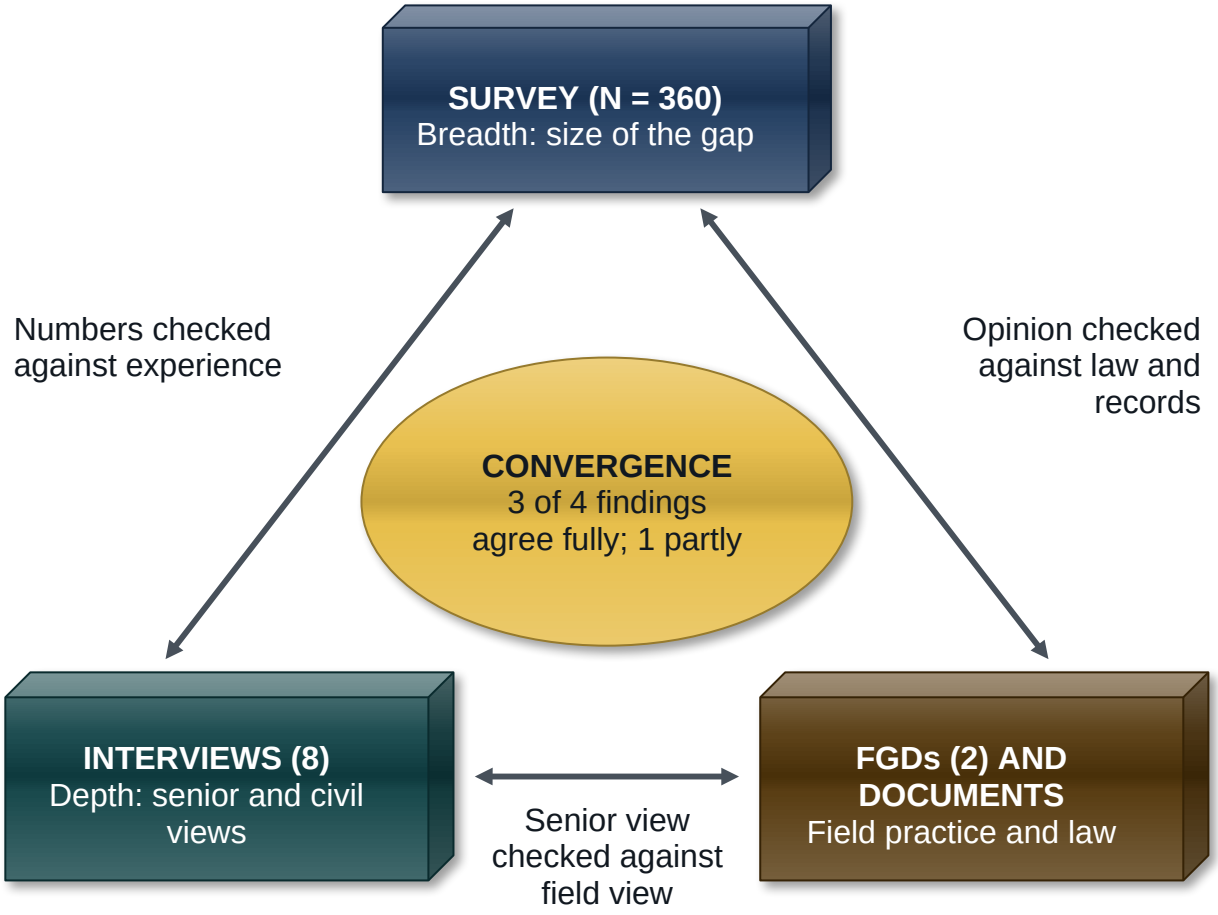
Note. The survey instrument is at Annexure A. Interview and FGD summaries are at Annexures D and E.

Data Analysis

Survey answers were coded and analysed with frequencies, percentages and mean scores (Annexure B). Mean scores were read against the bands in Table 1.5. Groups were compared by the difference in percentages, and the main differences were checked with a two-proportion z-test. Interview and FGD records were analysed by theme (Braun & Clarke, 2006). Findings from each source were then compared, so that no argument rests on the survey alone (Figure 1.6). Figure 1.7 shows the flow of the research.

Figure 1.6

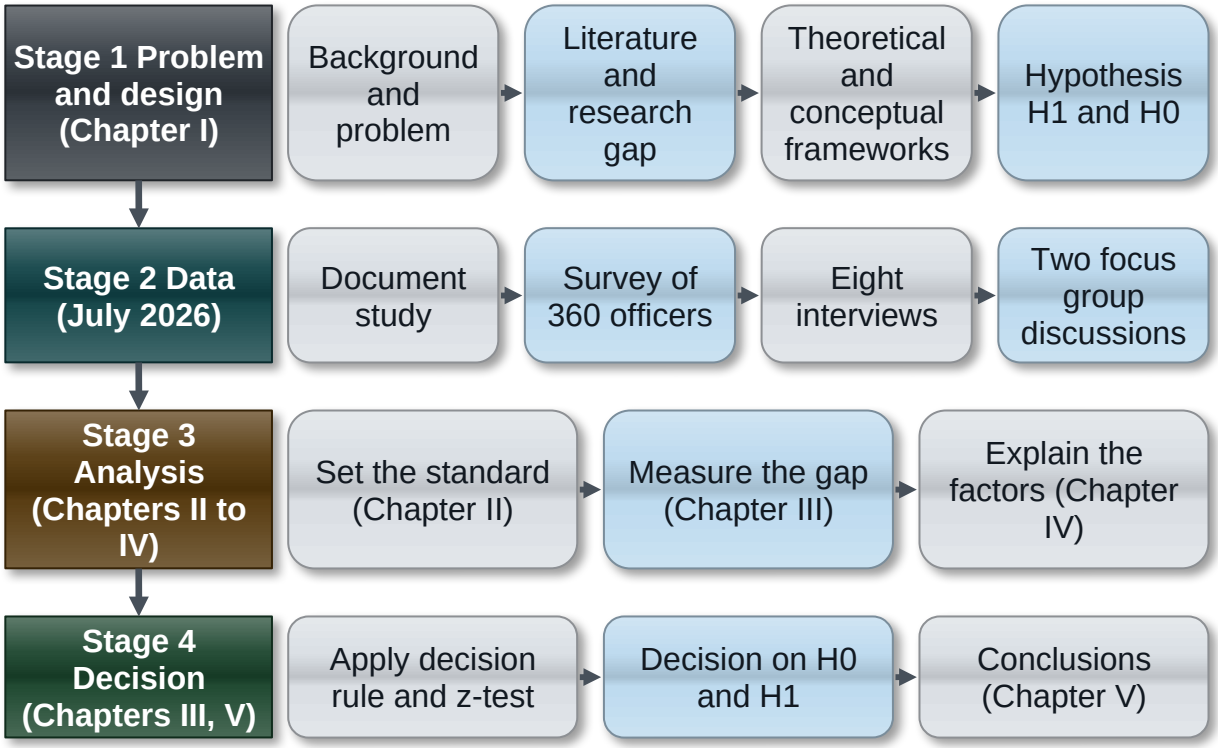
Triangulation of the Sources



Note. Researcher's own construct based on Table 3.7.

Figure 1.7

Research Flow from Problem to Test of the Hypothesis



Note. Researcher's own construct. H0 = null hypothesis; H1 = alternative hypothesis.

Table 1.5

Bands Used to Interpret Mean Scores

Six-point mean	Knowledge level	Five-point mean	Frequency or agreement
1.00 to 1.82	Very limited	1.00 to 1.79	Never; strongly disagree
1.83 to 2.66	Limited	1.80 to 2.59	Rarely; disagree
2.67 to 3.49	Moderate	2.60 to 3.39	Sometimes; neutral
3.50 to 4.32	Adequate	3.40 to 4.19	Often; agree
4.33 to 5.16	High	4.20 to 5.00	Always; strongly agree
5.17 to 6.00	Very high	Not applicable	Not applicable

Note. Researcher's own construct. Each scale is divided into bands of equal width.

Scope and Limitations

Scope

The study covers Bangladesh Army officers up to the rank of lieutenant colonel with experience in aid to civil administration. It excludes junior commissioned officers, other ranks, the Navy and the Air Force.

Limitations

a. Knowledge was self-assessed rather than tested. Professionals tend to rate themselves generously, so the true gap may be larger than reported.
b. Serving officers may have softened criticism of their institution, although answers were analysed only in aggregate.
c. Some opinion items drew agreement of 85% or more. Such items may have become truisms, since few officers would disagree with them. They are therefore used only as supporting evidence. The main tests rest on knowledge ratings and the reported frequency of problems, and each is checked against interviews, FGDs and documents.
d. The magistracy arrangement changed several times, so the findings need periodic review.

Chapterisation

The paper is arranged in five chapters.

a. Chapter I states the background and problem of the research, its theoretical basis and its design.
b. Chapter II sets the standard of knowledge that an officer needs to discharge the authority given during aid to civil administration duties.
c. Chapter III measures the existing knowledge of officers against that standard and tests the hypothesis.
d. Chapter IV analyses the factors behind the knowledge gap.
e. Chapter V presents the conclusions, the ways forward and the recommendations.

Chapter II
Expected Level of Knowledge Needed from Officers

General

Chapter I showed that the Army's role in aid to civil administration has grown faster than its preparation. A gap, however, can only be measured against a known requirement. No written standard of civil administration knowledge exists for Army officers, even after magistracy powers were given in 2024. This chapter builds one. It draws the requirement from theory, sets out what the law requires and what the deployments of 2024 to 2026 demanded in practice, and then sets a standard in six domains. Finally, it compares that standard with the views of officers and experts, with Army doctrine and with the practice of comparable institutions.

Requirement of the Theories

The theories reviewed in Chapter I lead to one requirement. A civil role carries risk without civil knowledge (Huntington, 1957; Janowitz, 1960), knowledge follows only from investment in training (Becker, 1964), and knowledge can be written down and tested (Spencer & Spencer, 1993). The Army therefore needs a written standard that is taught and assessed before an officer exercises civil powers.

What the Law Requires

The law is the most precise source, because it states what an officer may and may not do. Sections 12(1) and 17 of the CrPC allow the government to confer magistracy powers under the District Magistrate. Chapter IX of the CrPC (Sections 127 to 132) governs the dispersal of unlawful assemblies and requires an officer commanding troops to use as little force as possible. The Constitution, the arrest safeguards recently inserted into the CrPC and the guidelines of the Appellate Division protect every arrested person (*Bangladesh v. Bangladesh Legal Aid and Services Trust*, 2016; Code of Criminal Procedure (Amendment) Act, 2026). The Penal Code and the Torture and Custodial Death (Prevention) Act make the officer personally liable for wrongful confinement and ill-treatment (Penal Code, 1860; Torture and Custodial Death (Prevention) Act, 2013).

Two limits in the law deserve particular attention. Sections 129 and 131, which deal with the use of military force, were not delegated to Army officers (The Daily Star, 2024c), so the decision to use military force remains with the senior civil magistrate. In

addition, Section 132 protects only acts done lawfully and in good faith (Code of Criminal Procedure, 1898). An officer who does not know these limits may therefore exceed the authority given and, at the same time, lose the protection of the law.

What the Deployments Demanded

The deployments of 2024 to 2026 show how the law was used in practice. Officers arrested suspects, executed warrants, searched premises, recovered looted weapons, dispersed crowds and secured polling centres (Sarkar, 2024; The Business Standard, 2024c, 2026). Table 2.1 links the main tasks to the provisions involved and to the knowledge they demanded. Every task drew on at least two domains, and most tasks touched the two domains where an error is most costly, magistracy procedure and human rights compliance.

Table 2.1

Tasks of the 2024 to 2026 Deployments and the Knowledge They Demanded

Task	Main provisions	Knowledge domains demanded
Arrest of offenders and execution of warrants	CrPC ss. 64, 65, 83 to 86; Constitution Art. 33	Civil law; magistracy procedure; human rights compliance
Search and seizure, including recovery of looted weapons	CrPC ss. 100, 103, 105	Civil law; magistracy procedure; inter-agency coordination
Security proceedings for keeping the peace	CrPC ss. 107 to 110, 126	Magistracy procedure; civil law
Dispersal of unlawful assemblies	Penal Code s. 141; CrPC ss. 127, 128, 130	Crowd management; human rights compliance; civil-military communication
Removal of public nuisance	CrPC ss. 133, 142	Magistracy procedure; inter-agency coordination

Task	Main provisions	Knowledge domains demanded
Custody and handover of arrested persons	CrPC ss. 46A, 61, 167; Torture and Custodial Death (Prevention) Act, 2013	Human rights compliance; civil law
Election security and joint operations with police and civil officials	CrPC s. 17(1); deployment circulars	Inter-agency coordination; civil-military communication

Note. Based on The Daily Star (2024c), Sarkar (2024), The Business Standard (2024c, 2026) and Annexure C.

Knowledge Domains and the Required Standard

Table 2.3 groups the legal provisions into six domains and grades each domain by the cost of an error (Table 2.2). An error in magistracy procedure or human rights compliance can void an order, harm a citizen and expose the officer to prosecution, so these two domains are graded critical. An error in civil law, crowd management or civil-military communication can lose a case or lead to unlawful force, so these domains are graded severe. An error in inter-agency coordination mainly causes delay and friction and is graded moderate. The full text and source of each provision are given in Annexure C.

Table 2.2

Domain Consequence Heat Matrix

Domain	Order void or case lost	Harm to a citizen	Personal liability	Mission delay	Reputation	Score	Grade
Magistracy procedure	High	Medium	High	Medium	High	**13**	**Critical**
Human rights compliance	Medium	High	High	Low	High	**12**	**Critical**
Civil law	High	Medium	Medium	Medium	Medium	**11**	**Severe**
Crowd management	Low	High	Medium	Medium	High	**11**	**Severe**
Civil-military comm.	Low	Medium	Medium	High	Medium	**10**	**Severe**
Inter-agency coordination	Low	Low	Low	High	Medium	**8**	**Moderate**

Note. Researcher's assessment from the legal consequences above. High = 3, Medium = 2, Low = 1. Score 12 or more = critical; 10 to 11 = severe; 9 or less = moderate.

Table 2.3

Knowledge Domains, Legal Basis, Grade and Required Standard

Domain	Main legal basis	Grade	Basic (%)	Working (%)	Advanced (%)
Civil law	CrPC ss. 46 to 46E, 54A, 61, 100, 103, 105, 167; Evidence Act ss. 24 to 26	Severe	40-50	55-65	70-80
Magistracy procedure	CrPC ss. 12(1), 64, 65, 83 to 86, 107 to 110, 126, 133, 142	Critical	35-45	50-60	65-75
Inter-agency coordination	CrPC s. 17(1); Police Act ss. 23, 30, 30A, 31; deployment circulars	Moderate	40-50	55-65	70-80
Human rights compliance	Constitution Arts. 27, 31 to 33, 35(5); Penal Code ss. 220, 330, 342; Torture Act; Children Act ss. 44, 45	Critical	50-60	65-75	80-90
Crowd management	Constitution Art. 37; Penal Code ss. 96 to 106, 141; CrPC ss. 127, 128	Severe	45-55	60-70	75-85
Civil-military communication	CrPC ss. 129 to 132	Severe	45-55	60-70	70-80

Note. Based on the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1898; the Constitution of the People's Republic of Bangladesh (1972); the Penal Code, 1860; the Evidence Act, 1872; the Police Act, 1861; the Children Act, 2013; and the Torture and Custodial Death (Prevention) Act, 2013. Values are percentages of the scale maximum, so that they can be compared directly with the survey scores in Chapter III. On the six-point scale, 50% equals a mean of 3.0 and 65% a mean of 3.9.

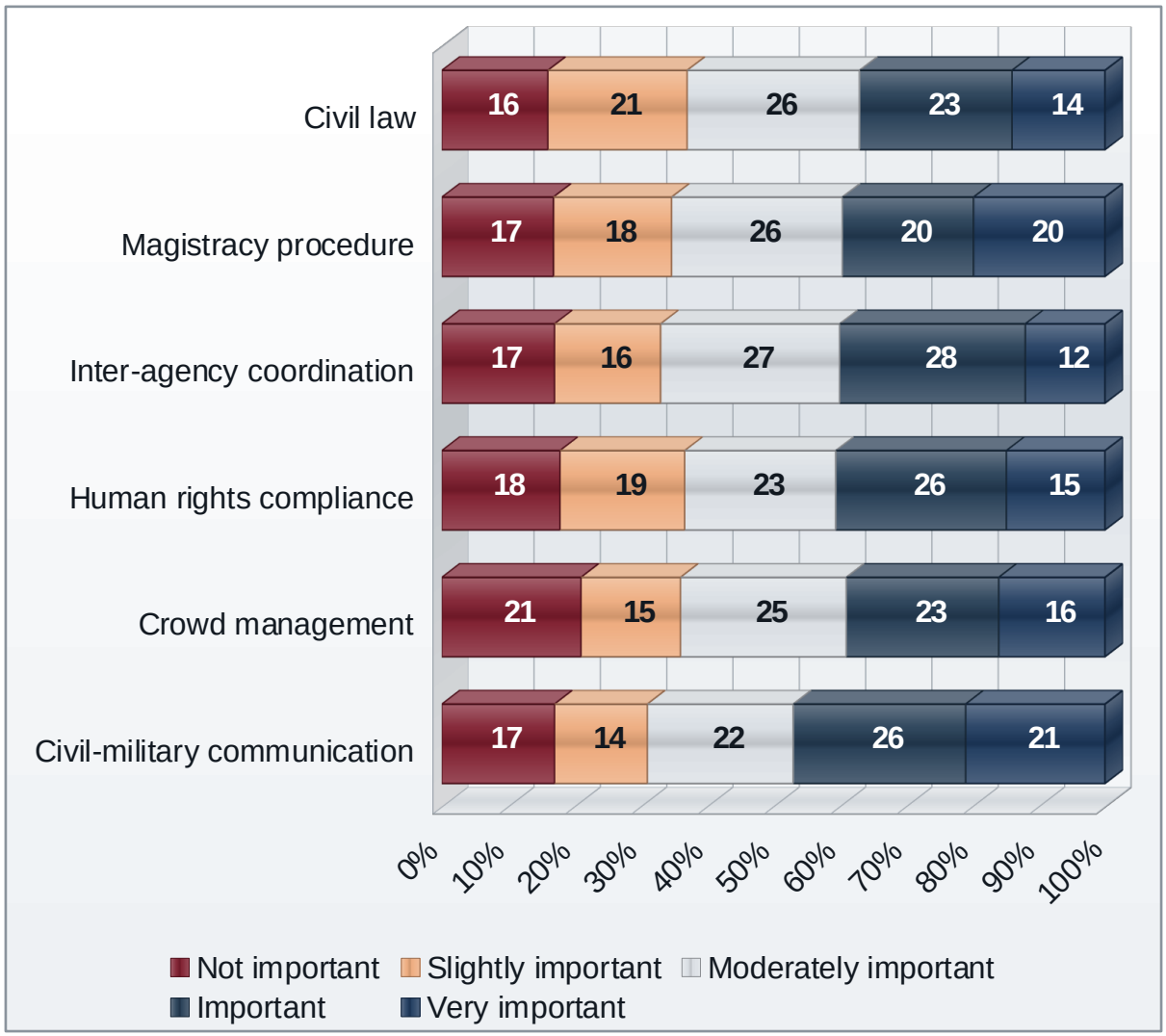
The working level is the minimum for any officer deployed in aid to civil administration. Its lower limit rises with the cost of an error. It is set at 55% where an error mainly causes delay or a weak case, 60% where it can lead to unlawful force, and 65% where it can breach constitutional rights. Magistracy procedure is set at 50% for all officers, because not every officer holds magistracy powers. An officer who holds them, however, needs the advanced level of 65%.

Officers' View of the Required Knowledge

Officers were asked to rate the importance of each domain. Between 63.2% and 68.6% rated each domain at least moderately important (Figure 2.1). Civil-military communication (68.6%) and inter-agency coordination (67.2%) were rated highest, and civil law (63.2%) lowest. Only 12.2% to 21.1% rated any domain very important.

Figure 2.1

Officers' Rating of the Importance of Each Knowledge Domain



Note. N = 360 (359 for civil law). Bar values are percentages of officers.

Officers appear to rate the domains by how often they meet them in the field, not by the legal consequence of an error. Human rights compliance, a critical domain, is rated no higher than the others. Officer opinion therefore confirms the domains but cannot set the level of the standard. The level must come from the law and the consequence of error.

Experts' View of the Required Knowledge

The officials who work with Army officers in the field named the same domains. The DC of Sylhet listed magisterial procedure, evidence requirements under the CrPC and civil-military jurisdiction as the core needs (Md. A. A. Mamun, personal communication, July 2026). The SP of Sylhet added arrest procedure, evidence

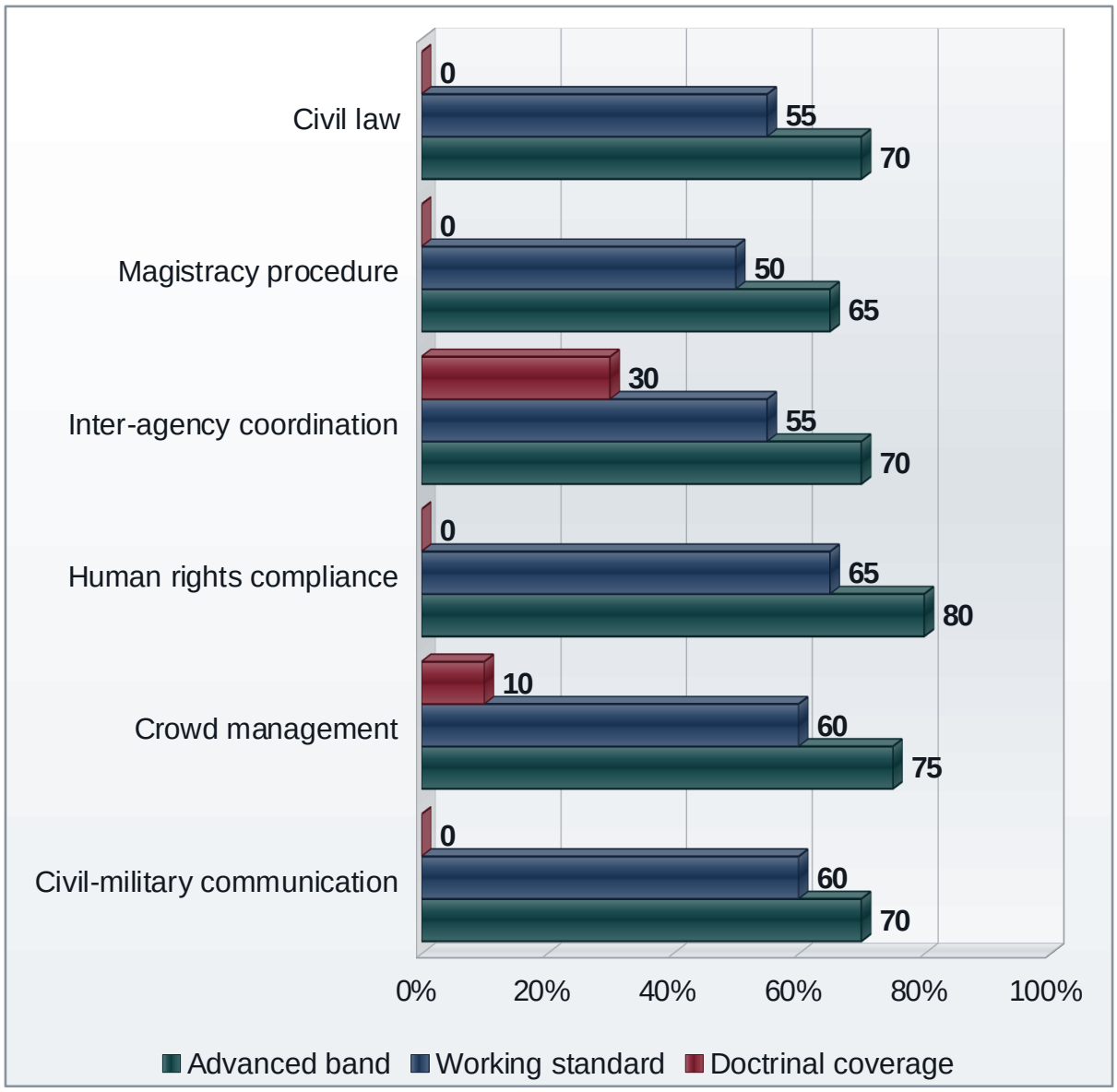
preservation and human rights compliance (R. Kabir, personal communication, July 2026). The Director of Military Training compared the need with the legal training given to a judicial probationer (Md. H. Kabir, personal communication, July 14, 2026). The Director of Infantry named the legal threshold for dispersing an assembly and the rules for working with police during a magistrate-led operation (M. M. H. Chowdhury, personal communication, July 14, 2026).

Coverage in Army Doctrine

MOOTW Volume I is built around disaster management. It lists the functions of civil administration and of law-enforcement agencies only as orientation topics. Volume II trains internal security drills such as cordon and search, roadblocks and apprehension, but without the CrPC provisions under which these acts must be done (ARTDOC, 2016a, 2016b). Neither volume covers magistracy procedure, the documentation of arrest and seizure, custodial safeguards or the legal thresholds for dispersal. Coded on the same scale as the standard, the doctrine covers about 30% of inter-agency coordination, 10% of crowd management and none of the other four domains (Figure 2.2). The shortfall against the working standard therefore ranges from 25 to 65 points.

Figure 2.2

Doctrinal Coverage Against the Required Standard by Domain



Note. Coverage is the researcher's coding of ARTDOC (2016a, 2016b) on the same percentage scale as the standard. Gap = working standard minus doctrinal coverage.

International Practice

Comparable institutions teach and test the same domains before they give authority (Table 2.4). The United Kingdom treats knowledge of local authorities, the legal basis of military action and inter-agency coordination as a taught prerequisite for military aid to the civil authorities (UK Ministry of Defence, 2017). The United Nations runs a standing civil-military coordination course and field handbook (United Nations

Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs, 2015). Regional studies identify structured instruction and joint training as the features that separate effective from weak coordination (Croissant et al., 2013; Ries, 2022). At home, civil magistrates and police officers, who use the same powers, are trained for months before they act (Bangladesh Civil Service Administration Academy, n.d.; Rtv News, 2024).

Table 2.4

Benchmark Matrix of Comparable Institutions

Institution	Formal course before authority	Written rules or handbook	Standing curriculum	Joint civil-military training	Source
Executive magistrates (Bangladesh)	**Yes**	Not found	**Yes**	Not found	BCS Administration Academy (n.d.)
ASPs (Bangladesh Police)	**Yes**	Not found	**Yes**	Not found	Rtv News (2024)
United Kingdom armed forces	**Yes**	**Yes**	Not found	**Yes**	UK Ministry of Defence (2017)
United Nations	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**	UNOCHA (2015)
United States armed forces	**Yes**	Not found	**Yes**	Not found	Kent (2022)
Indian Army	Not found	**Yes**	Not found	Not found	Naga People's Movement (1998); PIB (2019)
Bangladesh Army (present)	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	Survey and interviews

Note. Researcher's coding. Yes = documented in the source; Not found = not documented in the sources reviewed; No = absent on the evidence of this study. UNOCHA = United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs; PIB = Press Information Bureau.

Expected Standard by Domain

Taken together, the five sources fix the standard shown in Table 2.3. The working standard ranges from 50% to 65% of the scale maximum, with 65% in magistracy procedure for officers who hold magistracy powers. Officers, experts and comparable institutions confirm the six domains. The law and the consequence of error fix the level within each domain.

Analysis

The five sources agree on what officers must know but differ on how much it matters. Officers rate all six domains as moderately important, while the law treats magistracy procedure and human rights compliance as critical. This difference matters. If the standard were set from officer opinion, it would be set too low in exactly the domains where an error is least forgiven. The standard was therefore anchored to the law and to the consequence of error.

The doctrine review adds a second point. The Army's own texts supply between none and 30% of the required knowledge. An officer who studied every approved text would still fall short of the standard. The gap is therefore built into the system before any officer is deployed. Finally, every comparable institution in Table 2.4 teaches and tests before it delegates, while the Army delegates first. This sets the expectation for Chapter III: officers' knowledge is likely to fall short in every domain, and the shortfall is unlikely to close with experience alone.

Summary of the Chapter

Chapter II set the expected level of knowledge for officers in aid to civil administration duties. Theory, law, deployment practice, expert views and international practice identified six domains. Each domain was graded by the cost of an error and set at three levels, with a working standard of 50% to 65% of the scale maximum and 65% in magistracy procedure for officers who hold magistracy powers. Army doctrine covers between none and 30% of this standard. The chapter thus answers the first secondary question. Chapter III measures officers' existing knowledge against this standard.

Chapter III
Existing State of Knowledge and Identified Gaps

General

This chapter measures the present knowledge of officers against the standard set in Chapter II. It describes the respondents, examines knowledge overall and by domain, and tests whether experience improves it. It then examines the effect of the gap on performance and tests the hypothesis. Survey results are checked throughout against the interviews, the FGDs and the documents.

Profile of the Respondents

Table 3.1 shows the profile of the 360 respondents. Captains and majors make up 78.1% of the sample. These are the ranks that carried most ground duties. In addition, 90.0% had worked jointly with the civil administration.

Table 3.1

Profile of the Survey Respondents

Characteristic	Category	*n*	%
Rank	Lieutenant	66	18.3
	Captain	152	42.2
	Major	129	35.8
	Lieutenant colonel	13	3.6
Length of service	0 to 8 years	227	63.1
	8 to 15 years	98	27.2
	15 to 20 years	34	9.4
	Above 20 years	1	0.3
Deployments in aid to civil administration	1 to 3 times	273	75.8
	3 to 5 times	43	11.9
	More than 5 times	23	6.4
	Not recorded	21	5.8

Characteristic	Category	*n*	%
Institutional training on civil administration	No	206	57.2
	Yes	109	30.3
	Not sure	42	11.7
	Not recorded	3	0.8

Note. N = 360.

Reliability of the Data

All 360 responses were complete on the knowledge and effect questions. However, 80 officers gave the same answer to all nine knowledge questions. The main results were therefore recalculated without these 80 responses (Table B2). Knowledge changed only from 39.3% to 38.9% of the maximum, and every difference between groups stayed above the 10-point threshold of the decision rule. The data were accepted as reliable.

Overall Level of Knowledge

Officers' Own View

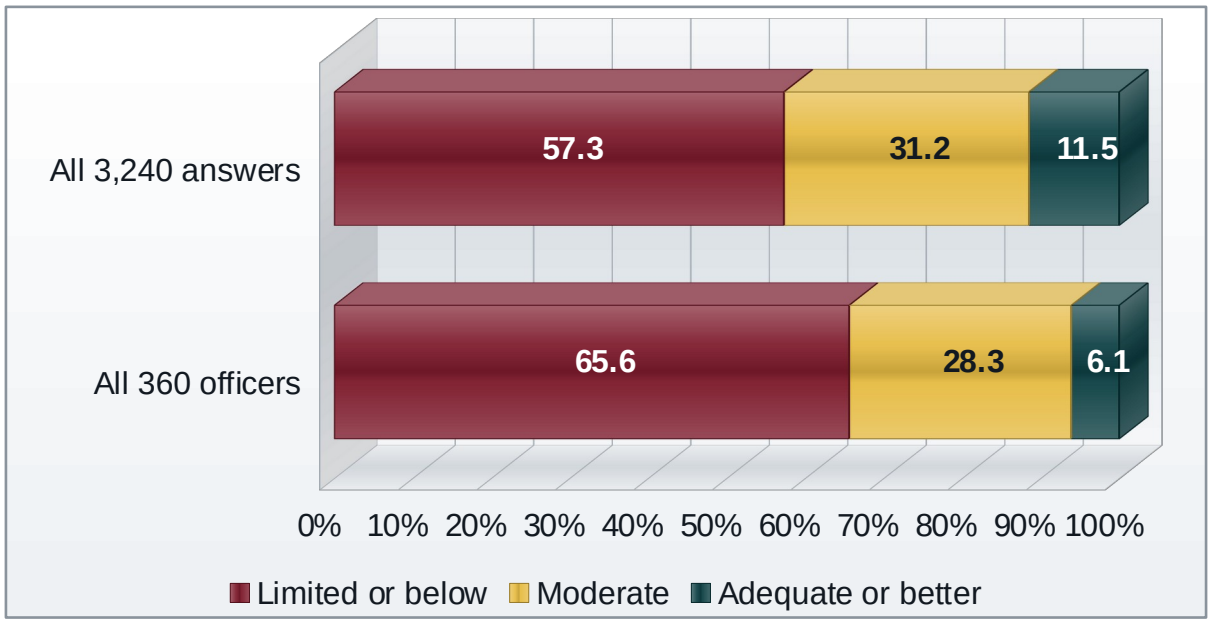
In the survey, 51.9% of officers called the knowledge gap highly significant and 39.7% moderate. Only 4.4% considered present knowledge adequate. Together, 91.6% agree that a gap exists. A figure this high may reflect a truism, since few officers would deny that more training would help. This result is therefore not used as proof. The study relies instead on the knowledge ratings below, which ask about specific legal tasks. Independent sources point the same way. The SP of Sylhet rated Army units 8 to 9 out of 10 for tactical tasks but only 4 to 5 for civil functions, and the DC rated their preparedness 5 out of 10 (R. Kabir, personal communication, July 2026; Md. A. A. Mamun, personal communication, July 2026).

Distribution of Ratings

Officers rated their knowledge on nine questions using a six-point scale. Of all 3,240 answers, 57.3% were limited or very limited, 31.2% moderate and only 11.5% adequate or better (Figure 3.1). As many as 60.8% of officers did not rate any question above moderate, and only 5.8% rated five or more questions adequate or better.

Figure 3.1

Distribution of Knowledge Ratings Across Answers and Officers



Note. N = 360 officers and 3,240 answers. An officer's level is the mean of the officer's nine answers, read against Table 1.5.

The mean of all answers is 2.36, or 39.3% of the maximum score, which lies in the limited band. At officer level, 65.6% have limited knowledge, 28.3% moderate knowledge and only 6.1% adequate or better. Every one of the nine questions has a mean in the limited band, from 2.22 to 2.43. The FGDs show how officers filled this gap in practice. Junior officers learned from NCOs, adjutants and a summary circulated on WhatsApp; as one put it, "that PDF was our training" (Annexure E).

Knowledge by Domain

Domain Scorecard

Table 3.2 is a scorecard of the six domains. It compares existing knowledge with the working standard and shows the main problem linked to each domain.

Table 3.2

Scorecard of Knowledge, Gap and Effect by Domain

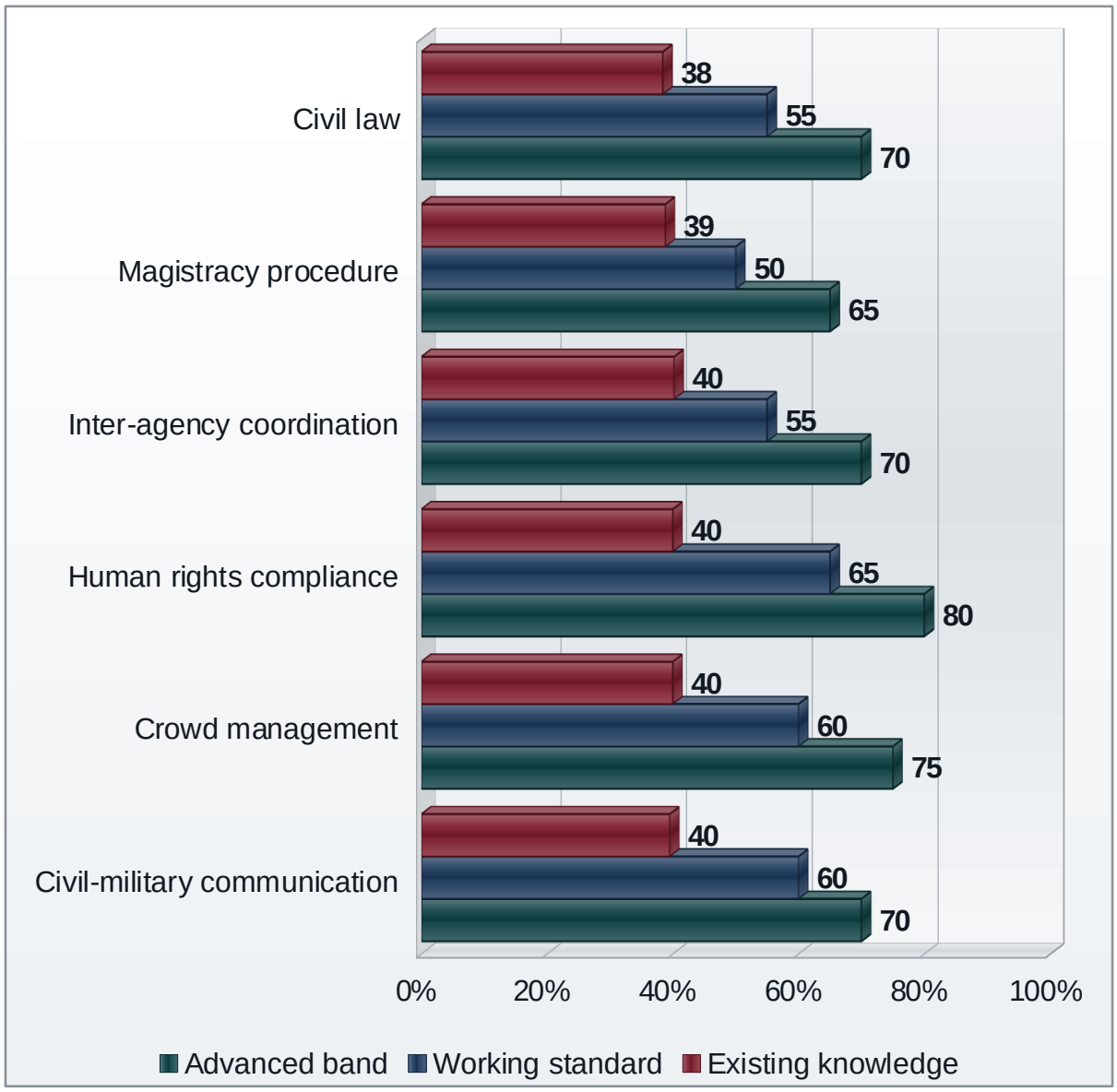
Domain	*M*	Existing (%)	Standard (%)	Gap (points)	Limited (%)	Main problem, limited vs others (%)
Civil law	2.30	38.4	55	16.6	69.7	Documentation errors 69.3 vs 41.3
Magistracy procedure	2.33	38.8	50 (65)	11.2 (26.2)	67.8	Over-reliance 68.9 vs 33.6
Inter-agency coordination	2.41	40.2	55	14.8	54.2	Friction 73.8 vs 37.0
Human rights compliance	2.40	40.0	65	25.0	65.8	Hesitation 76.4 vs 47.2
Crowd management	2.40	40.0	60	20.0	53.9	Hesitation 79.9 vs 50.6
Civil-military communication	2.37	39.5	60	20.5	59.2	Friction 71.8 vs 35.4

Note. N = 360. M = mean on the six-point scale; Existing = M as a percentage of the maximum; Standard = working standard from Table 2.3, with the standard for officers holding magistracy powers in brackets; Gap = Standard minus Existing; Limited = officers with a domain mean below 2.67. Problems are the share meeting the problem often or always.

Every domain falls short of the working standard (Figure 3.2; Figure 3.3). The gap ranges from 11.2 points in magistracy procedure to 25.0 points in human rights compliance. For officers who hold magistracy powers, the magistracy gap widens to 26.2 points, the largest of all. Even against a flat standard of 50%, each domain still falls short, by 9.8 to 11.6 points.

Figure 3.2

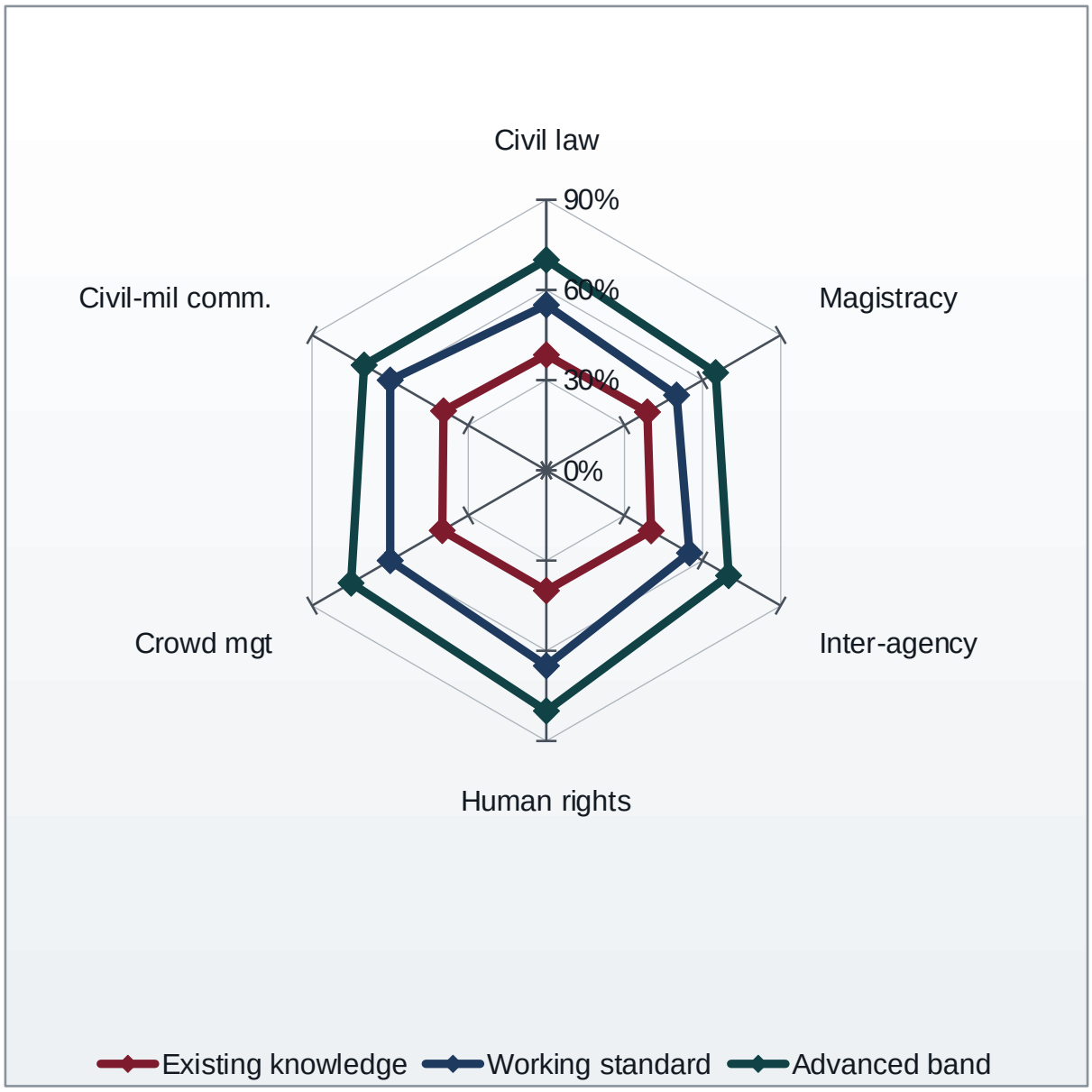
Knowledge Gap by Domain in Three Dimensions



Note. N = 360. Existing = domain mean as a percentage of the scale maximum. Standards are from Table 2.3.

Figure 3.3

Knowledge Profile Radar



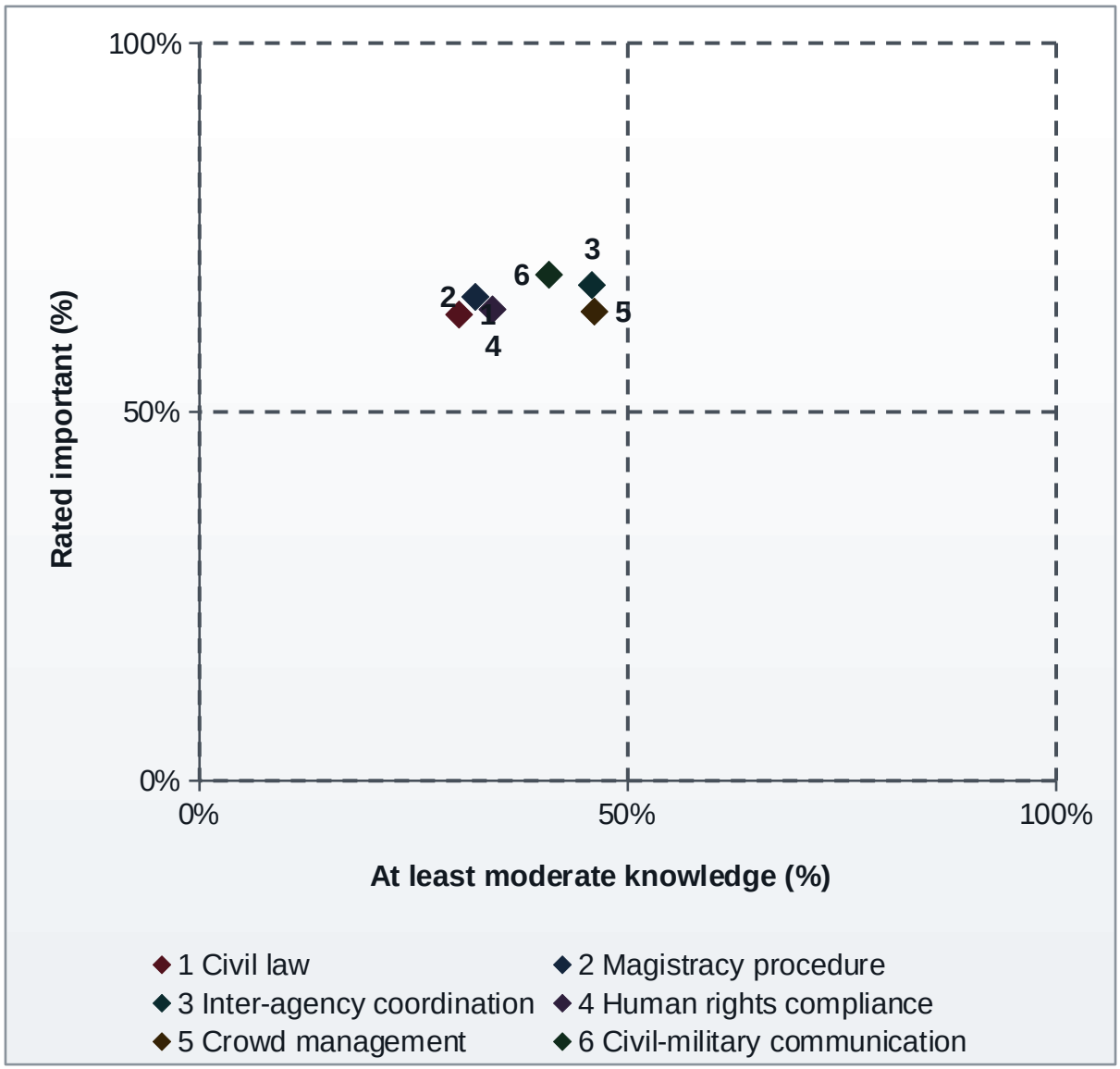
Note. N = 360. Values are percentages of the scale maximum.

Importance Against Knowledge

Figure 3.4 compares the share of officers who rate each domain important with the share who have at least moderate knowledge of it. In every domain the first exceeds the second, by 17.5 to 33.4 points. The widest gaps are in magistracy procedure (33.4 points) and civil law (32.9 points). These are the two domains used most directly under the 2024 powers (Table 2.1). Officers thus value the knowledge but do not hold it.

Figure 3.4

Importance and Knowledge Priority Quadrant



Note. N = 360 (359 for civil law). Top-left = high importance, low knowledge (urgent); top-right = maintain; bottom-left = monitor; bottom-right = possible over-investment.

Areas with Larger Gaps

Magistracy Procedure

Magistracy procedure is graded critical (Table 3.3), because it is the domain in which an officer exercises legal power directly. On this question, 63.6% of officers rated themselves limited or below. Asked where officers feel least confident, 65.8% named the application of magistracy powers within legal limits and 57.2% named documentation for arrests, searches and evidence (Figure 3.5).

Table 3.3

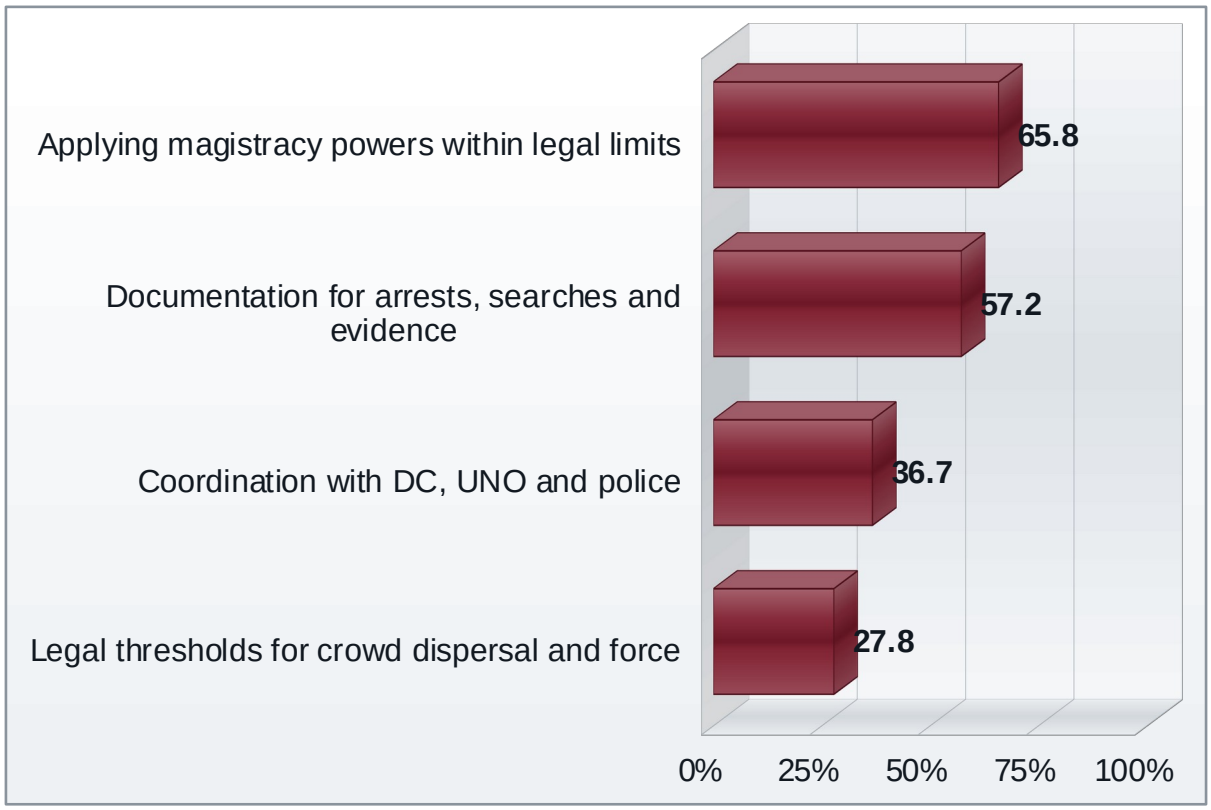
Risk Matrix of the Six Knowledge Domains

Likelihood (officers limited)	1 Negligible	2 Minor	3 Moderate	4 Severe	5 Critical
5 Almost certain (70%+)					
4 Likely (60% to 69%)				Civil law	Magistracy procedure Human rights
3 Possible (50% to 59%)			Inter-agency	Crowd management Civil-military comm.	
2 Unlikely (40% to 49%)					
1 Rare (below 40%)					

Note. Likelihood from Table 3.2; consequence from the grades in Table 2.3. Red = high risk; amber = medium; green = low.

Figure 3.5

Topics on Which Officers Feel Least Confident



Note. N = 360. Officers could name more than one topic, so the percentages add to more than 100.

Among officers with limited knowledge in this domain, 68.9% report over-reliance on magistrates or police often or always, against 33.6% of the others. The civil side saw the effect. In Sylhet, detentions by troops were overturned and the High Court ordered scrutiny (Md. A. A. Mamun, personal communication, July 2026). In the battalion FGD, a company commander recalled exercising judicial power after "maybe two hours of lecture" (S. M. M. Islam, personal communication, July 22, 2026).

Human Rights Compliance

Human rights compliance is also graded critical. Its standard is the highest (65%), so its gap is the largest for officers in general (25.0 points). The DC observed force used in crowd control "without adequate de-escalation" (Md. A. A. Mamun, personal communication, July 2026). The SP pointed to female detainees held without female custody staff (R. Kabir, personal communication, July 2026). Hesitation is reported often or always by 76.4% of officers with limited knowledge in this domain, against 47.2% of the others.

The national record shows how much is at stake. Ain o Salish Kendra, a human rights organisation, recorded 38 extrajudicial killings in 2025, against 21 in 2024. Of these, 26 occurred in reported gunfights, through physical torture or in joint-forces custody (New Age, 2025). A single death in custody, as in Cumilla, can damage trust in the whole deployment (Chowdhury, 2025).

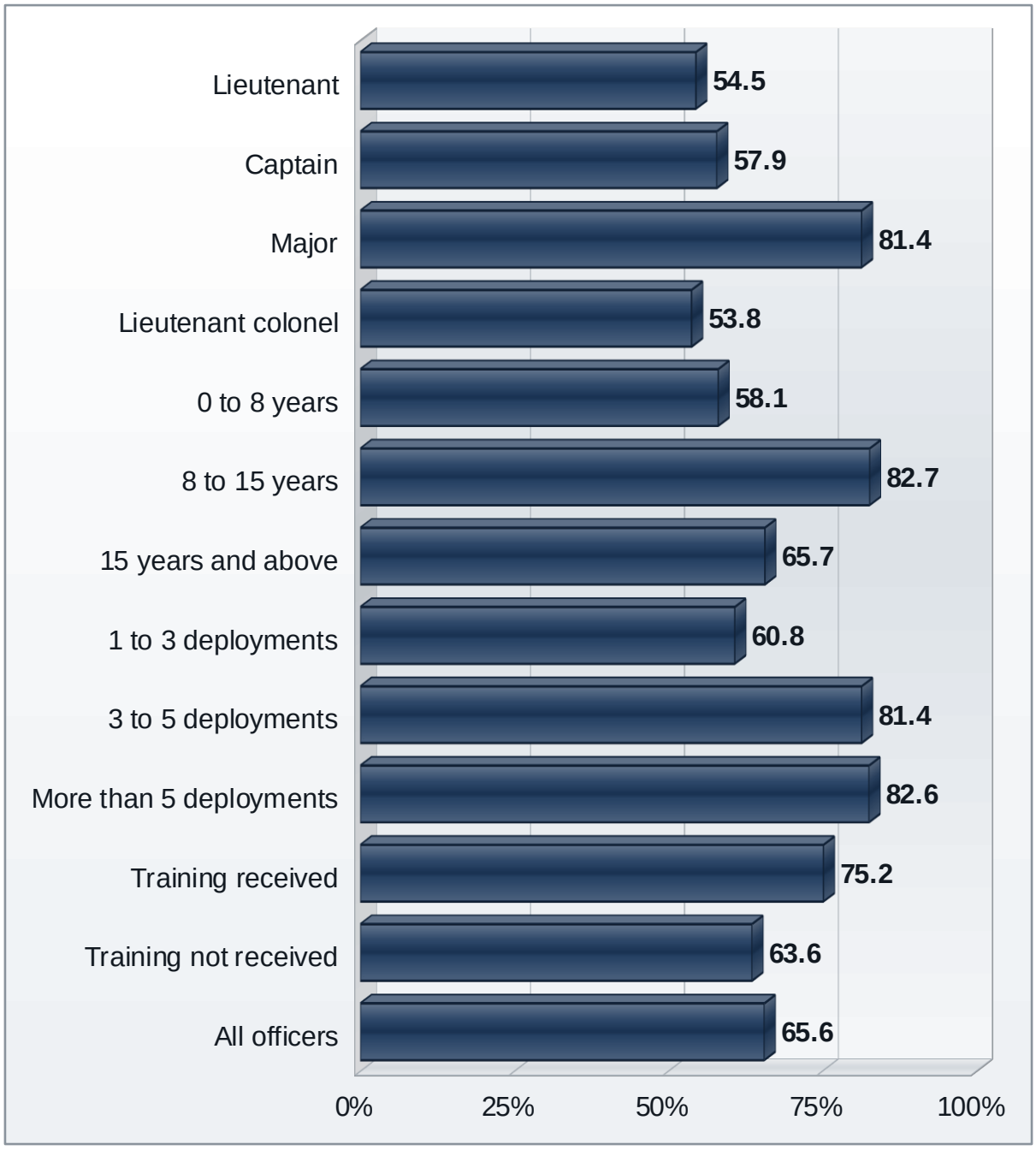
Experience Versus Knowledge

Rank, Service and Deployments

If experience built knowledge, senior and more deployed officers would know more. Figure 3.6 and Figure 3.7 show the opposite. The share with limited knowledge rises from 54.5% of lieutenants and 57.9% of captains to 81.4% of majors. It rises from 58.1% of officers with up to 8 years' service to 82.7% of those with 8 to 15 years. It also rises from 60.8% of officers with one to three deployments to 81.4% and 82.6% of those with more.

Figure 3.6

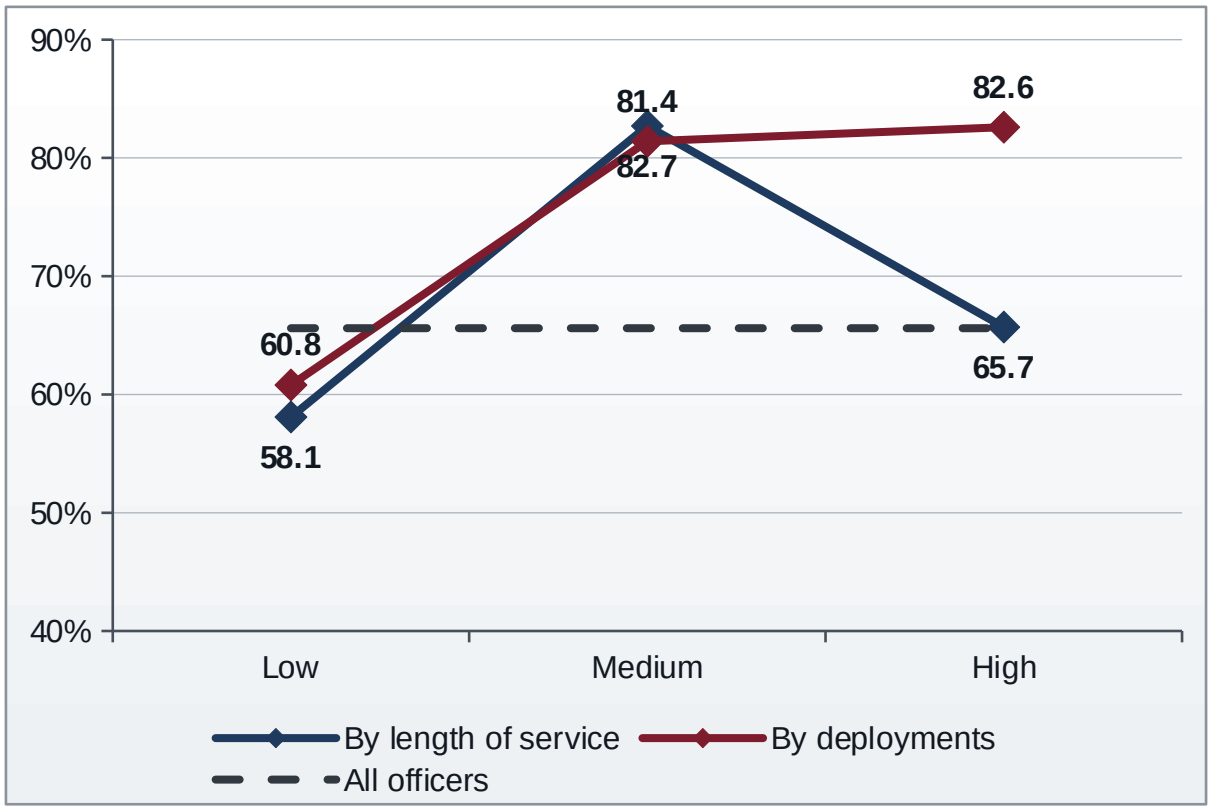
Share of Officers with Limited Knowledge by Rank, Service, Deployments and Training



Note. N = 360. Groups of fewer than 25 officers (lieutenant colonels, n = 13; more than 5 deployments, n = 23) should be read with caution.

Figure 3.7

Experience Gradient



Note. N = 360. Low, medium and high = 0 to 8, 8 to 15 and 15 or more years of service; 1 to 3, 3 to 5 and more than 5 deployments. Dashed line = all officers (65.6%).

Two explanations are possible. Experience may build routine without the legal base underneath it (Becker, 1964). Alternatively, officers who have faced more real legal decisions may be more aware of what they do not know. The share admitting hesitation also rises with rank, from 53.0% of lieutenants to 65.1% of majors and 69.2% of lieutenant colonels. Either way, experience brings familiarity but not the legal knowledge the task requires. The interviews qualify this finding in part: the DC and SP found senior officers better informed, and the FGDs credited earlier duties with some help (Table 3.7). The result should therefore be read as "experience is not enough", rather than "experience does not help".

Rank by Domain

Table 3.4 breaks knowledge down by rank and domain. Majors score lowest in every domain, from 2.05 in civil law to 2.17 in human rights compliance. Majors usually

command companies, the level at which most magistracy duties were performed (Table 3.1). The rank that needs the knowledge most therefore holds the least of it.

Table 3.4

Rank by Domain Heat Map

Rank	n	Civil law	Magistracy	Inter-agency	Human rights	Crowd mgt	Civil-mil comm.	Problems (%)
Lieutenant	66	2.50	2.55	2.65	2.74	2.73	2.65	**72.7**
Captain	152	2.45	2.43	2.61	2.46	2.47	2.49	**79.6**
Major	129	**2.05**	**2.09**	**2.06**	2.17	2.15	**2.06**	**93.8**
Lieutenant colonel	13	**2.12**	2.38	2.38	2.31	2.46	2.62	**84.6**
All officers	360	2.30	2.33	2.41	2.40	2.40	2.37	**83.6**

Note. Domain means on the six-point scale. Dark red below 2.15; light red 2.15 to 2.34; amber 2.35 to 2.54; light amber 2.55 to 2.66 (still limited). Problems = officers meeting at least one problem often or always.

Present Training

Officers who received institutional training score lower (2.13) than those who did not (2.43). They score lower in all six domains, most of all in magistracy procedure (2.02 against 2.45). Of the trained officers, 75.2% have limited knowledge, and 58.7% call the gap highly significant. The present training, mostly short briefings, appears to make officers aware of the gap without closing it. As the Director of Military Training put it, "briefings alone are not enough" (Md. H. Kabir, personal communication, July 14, 2026).

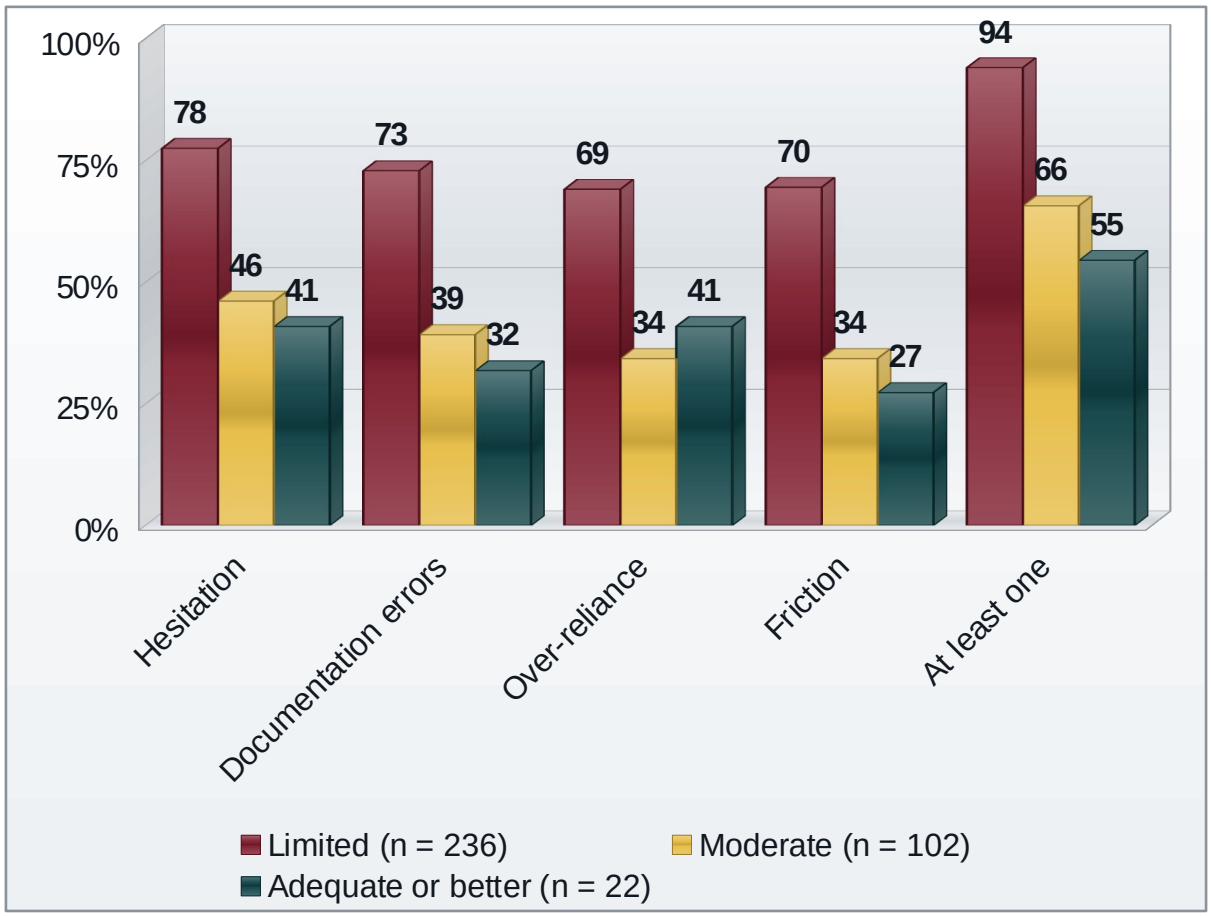
Effect of the Gap on Performance

Problems by Level of Knowledge

Officers' own admissions show the same pattern. Of officers with limited knowledge, 66.9% admit that they hesitated over a decision for lack of knowledge. The share falls to 47.1% at the moderate level and 22.7% at the adequate or better level. Figure 3.8 shows how often each group meets the four problems.

Figure 3.8

Problems on the Ground by Level of Knowledge in Three Dimensions



Note. N = 360. Values are the share of officers meeting each problem often or always.

Officers with limited knowledge meet each problem 32.3 to 36.4 points more often than the other officers. On average they meet the problems often (M = 3.95), while the others meet them only sometimes (M = 3.36). Each difference is statistically significant (z = 6.13 to 6.64, p < .001). The field record supports the survey. The SP reported arrests without recorded grounds and no chain of custody, and the DC reported searches without warrants and detentions beyond legal limits (Annexure D). A company commander described the outcome of the 2024 deployment as "luck, not design" (Annexure E).

Test of the Hypothesis

The decision rule set in Chapter I was applied to these results (Table 3.5).

Table 3.5

Test of the Hypothesis Against the Decision Rule

Condition	Evidence	Required	Met
1. Mean knowledge below the working standard in every domain	38.4% to 40.2% against standards of 50% to 65%; gaps of 11.2 to 25.0 points	All six domains	Yes
2. More than half of officers have limited knowledge	65.6% of officers	Above 50%	Yes
3. Officers with limited knowledge meet each problem more often, and significantly so	Differences of 32.3 to 36.4 points; z = 6.13 to 6.64, p < .001	At least 10 points on each problem; p < .05	Yes

Note. Differences compare officers with limited knowledge (n = 236) with those with moderate or better knowledge (n = 124). Two-proportion z-tests. Calculations are at Annexure B.

All three conditions are met by a wide margin. H0 is therefore rejected and H1 accepted. The civil administration knowledge of Bangladesh Army officers is inadequate, and the shortfall lowers their efficiency in aid to civil administration duties. The result holds when the 80 uniform responders are removed (Table B2). Table 3.6 gives the effect sizes and group tests. The interviews and FGDs agree with the survey on three of the four main findings and partly agree on the fourth (Table 3.7).

Table 3.6

Hypothesis Test Results Panel

Test	Groups compared	Statistic	p	Effect size
Does limited knowledge raise the problems? Two-proportion z-tests				
Hesitation	Limited (236) vs others (124)	z = 6.17	< .001	h = 0.68; OR = 4.18
Documentation errors	Limited vs others	z = 6.47	< .001	h = 0.72; OR = 4.41
Over-reliance	Limited vs others	z = 6.13	< .001	h = 0.69; OR = 4.06
Friction	Limited vs others	z = 6.64	< .001	h = 0.75; OR = 4.61
Does experience close the gap? Chi-square tests against limited knowledge				
Rank	Four ranks (N = 360)	$\chi^2(3) = 22.62$	< .001	V = 0.25
Service	Three bands (N = 360)	$\chi^2(2) = 18.20$	< .001	V = 0.22
Deployments	Three bands (N = 339)	$\chi^2(2) = 10.31$	.006	V = 0.17
Training	Trained vs untrained (N = 315)	$\chi^2(1) = 4.41$	.036	V = 0.12

Note. Computed from the counts reported in this paper. h = Cohen's h; OR = odds ratio (95% CI 2.6 to 7.3); V = Cramer's V. In the rank test the lieutenant colonel group has an expected count of 4.5, so read with caution.

Table 3.7

Evidence Convergence Matrix

Finding	Survey	Senior commanders	DC and SP	FGDs	Documents	Strength
Knowledge of the civil side is limited	●	●	●	●	●	**Strong**
Magistracy powers and documentation are weakest	●	●	●	●	●	**Strong**
Experience alone does not close the gap	●	●	○	○	–	**Moderate**
The gap causes problems on the ground	●	●	●	●	○	**Strong**
The causes are institutional	●	●	●	●	●	**Strong**

Note. Based on the survey, Annexures C to E and the doctrine review. ● = source supports the finding; ○ = supports with qualification; – = not addressed. Strong = four or more sources; Moderate = two or three.

Analysis

The findings say more than that knowledge is low. Three points stand out. First, the gap is uniform. The nine questions differ by only 0.21 points, and no domain reaches the standard. A uniform gap of this kind points to a common cause in the system, not to weak individuals or a single missing lesson.

Second, the gap grows where it should shrink. Majors, officers with 8 to 15 years' service and officers with many deployments are the most likely to have limited knowledge. Majors command companies, the level at which most magistracy duties were performed. The officers who use the powers most are therefore the least prepared to use them.

Third, the gap has a cost. A difference of 32 to 36 points in problems is too large and too consistent to be a chance effect, and the civil officials in Sylhet described the same faults independently. The present briefings do not solve the problem. Trained officers score lower, which suggests that short briefings expose the gap without closing it. These findings support Becker's (1964) view that knowledge follows investment, and they direct the search for causes towards the institution in Chapter IV.

Summary of the Chapter

Chapter III measured officers' knowledge against the standard of Chapter II. Officers' knowledge stands at 39.3% of the maximum, and 65.6% of officers have limited knowledge. Every domain falls short of the working standard, by 11.2 to 25.0 points, and by 26.2 points in magistracy procedure for officers who hold magistracy powers. Rank, service, deployments and present training do not close the gap. Officers with limited knowledge meet each problem 32 to 36 points more often, a significant difference. H0 was rejected and H1 accepted, which answers the second secondary question.

Chapter IV
Factors Affecting the Civil Administration Knowledge of Officers

General

Chapter III showed that officers' knowledge is limited and does not improve with rank, service or deployments. This points to causes within the system rather than in individual officers. This chapter identifies those causes, tests each one against more than one source, and shows how they reinforce each other.

Identifying the Factors of the Knowledge Gap

Five factors were put to officers in the survey, and a sixth emerged from the results of Chapter III (Figure 4.1). Each surveyed factor was accepted by at least 70% of officers (Table 4.1). Agreement at this level comes close to the range where an item may become a truism, so agreement alone is not treated as proof. Each factor was therefore tested against a hard indicator from the survey, the doctrine review or the interviews, and against the four groups of interviewees and FGD participants. Officers with limited knowledge agree with the factors more strongly (96.2% on average) than the others (66.1%). This suggests that the officers who feel the gap most see the same causes.

Table 4.1

Evidence for the Six Factors

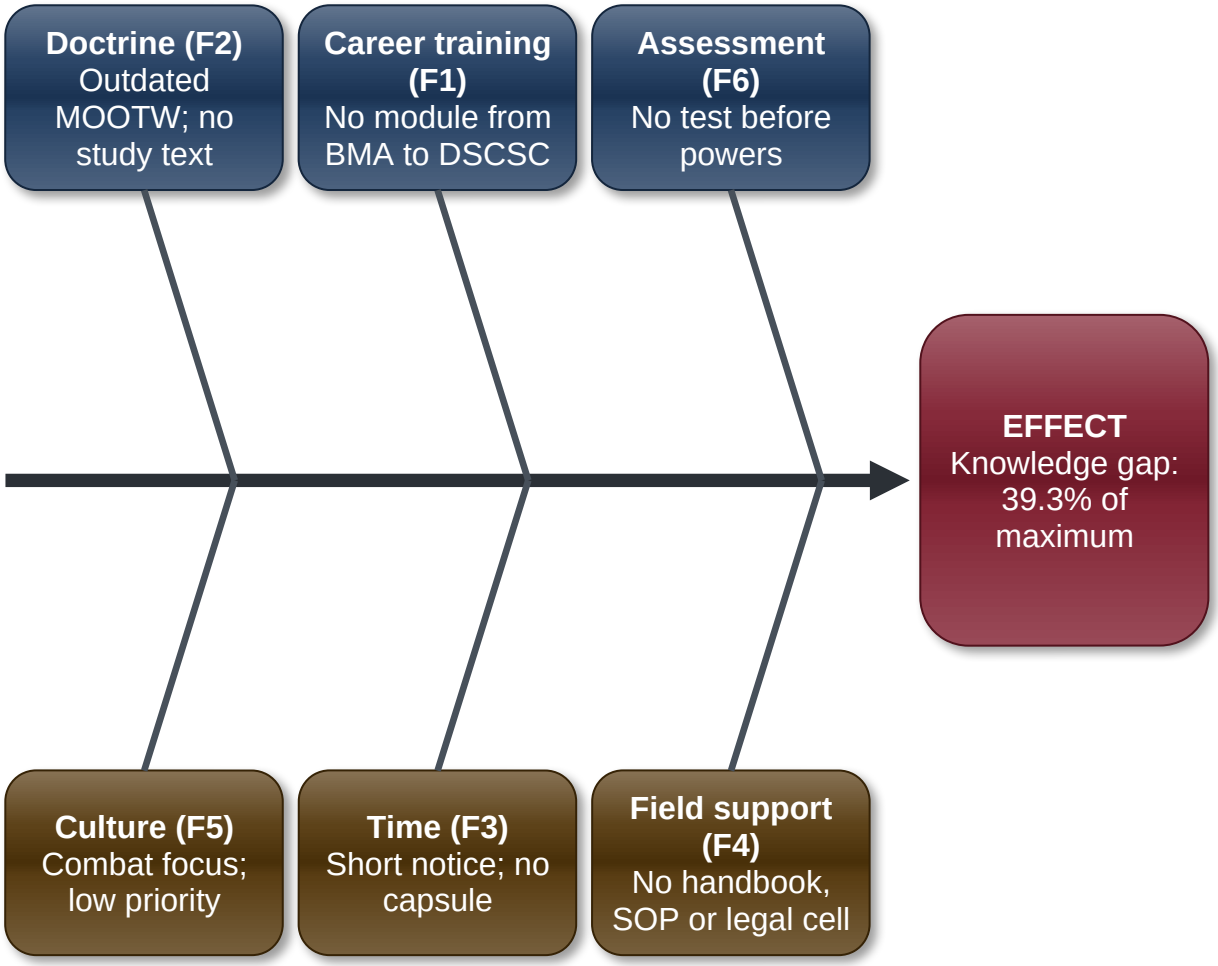
Factor	Hard indicator	Agreed (%)	Groups raising it (of 4)
F1 No module in career courses	78.9% say courses cover the subject poorly or not at all; 1.1% say "well"	79.4	4
F2 Outdated doctrine, no study material	Doctrine covers 0% to 30% of the standard (Chapter II)	75.8	4
F3 Short notice, no pre-deployment training	74.2% say preparation time is not assured	74.7	4

Factor	Hard indicator	Agreed (%)	Groups raising it (of 4)
F4 No field reference or legal support	No issued handbook or SOP; 57.2% least confident in documentation	70.6	4
F5 Low priority, combat-focused culture	83.3% say the training culture gives little or no emphasis	71.1	4
F6 Reliance on experience, no test	81.4% to 82.7% of the most experienced groups have limited knowledge	Tested in Chapter III	3

Note. Based on the survey (N = 360) and Annexures D and E. The four groups are the senior commanders, the DC and SP, the junior officers' FGD and the battalion FGD. SOP = standing operating procedure.

Figure 4.1

Fishbone Diagram of the Knowledge Gap



Note. Researcher's own construct from Table 4.1. Upper bones are structural causes (what is taught and tested); lower bones are environmental causes (how the Army works).

Factors Affecting the Knowledge

Factor 1: No Civil Administration Training in Career Courses

Asked how well the basic career courses cover civil administration, 38.6% of officers answered "not at all" and a further 40.3% "very poorly" or "poorly". Only 1.1% answered "well". The Director of Military Training described this as a training-to-task mismatch, in which the syllabi prepare officers for war but "spend very little time on the administrative skills that ACP actually demands" (Md. H. Kabir, personal communication, July 14, 2026). The Chief of General Staff likewise proposed teaching state structure at BMA and field legal powers in basic and junior staff courses (Md. M.

Rahman, personal communication, July 14, 2026). The gap therefore begins in initial training and is not corrected in later courses.

Factor 2: Outdated Doctrine and No Study Material

Training has to be conducted against doctrine. The MOOTW volumes, however, were issued in 2016 and do not cover the legal side of the task (Chapter II). Instructors therefore have no approved text to teach from. In the survey, 75.8% of officers agree that the lack of precise study material contributes to the gap. In the battalion FGD, the adjutant reported preparing the unit's formats and registers on his own, without guidance (Annexure E).

Factor 3: Short Notice and No Mandatory Pre-Deployment Training

Aid to civil administration deployments usually come at short notice. Only 25.8% of officers said that adequate time is generally given for legal and administrative preparation. Another 45.6% said "sometimes" and 28.6% said "no". At the same time, 74.7% agree that the lack of a mandatory pre-deployment capsule contributes to the gap. A company commander received "maybe two hours of lecture" before exercising judicial power in September 2024 (S. M. M. Islam, personal communication, July 22, 2026).

Factor 4: No Field Reference Material or Legal Support

During deployment, an officer who is unsure of the law has no issued reference to consult. In the survey, 70.6% of officers agree that the lack of field handbooks and standing operating procedures (SOPs) contributes to the gap. Legal advice is also thin. The Commander of 52 Infantry Brigade reported that the brigade's small legal cell was stretched across several units at once (S. Rahman, personal communication, July 14, 2026). A captain who telephoned the adjutant before a first mobile court duty was told, "I am reading the same document you are" (M. A. A. Ouikko, personal communication, July 20, 2026).

Factor 5: Low Priority and a Combat-Focused Training Culture

The Army's training culture also sustains the gap. In the survey, 71.1% of officers agree that differing views of senior leadership on the priority of the subject contribute to the gap. Asked how far the training culture emphasises civil administration, 83.3% answered "not at all" or "to a small extent", and only 1.4% "to a large extent". Commanders are assessed mainly on tactical readiness, so preparation

depends on individual initiative. One commanding officer explained that the battalion relied on his own briefings and SOPs: "that is Shafiq's system, not the Army's system; when I hand over, it goes with me" (Md. S. Islam, personal communication, July 22, 2026).

Factor 6: Reliance on Experience Without Any Test

The institution has assumed that officers will learn the civil side through experience and personal interest. Chapter III showed that this assumption fails, as 81.4% to 82.7% of the most experienced groups have limited knowledge. Without a foundation laid early in service, experience adds routine but not legal knowledge. There is also no test at any stage, so the gap stays hidden until it appears on the ground. The Commander of 52 Infantry Brigade summed up the remedy: "certification must come before delegation" (S. Rahman, personal communication, July 14, 2026).

How the Factors Reinforce Each Other

The six factors do not act alone. They form a cycle in which each sustains the next (Figure 4.2; Table 4.2). Outdated doctrine keeps the subject out of career courses. The absence of a module signals that the subject has low priority. Low priority leaves units without pre-deployment training when short-notice tasks arrive. Without field references or legal support, officers learn on the job. Because nothing is tested, the lessons never return to doctrine, and the cycle begins again.

Table 4.2

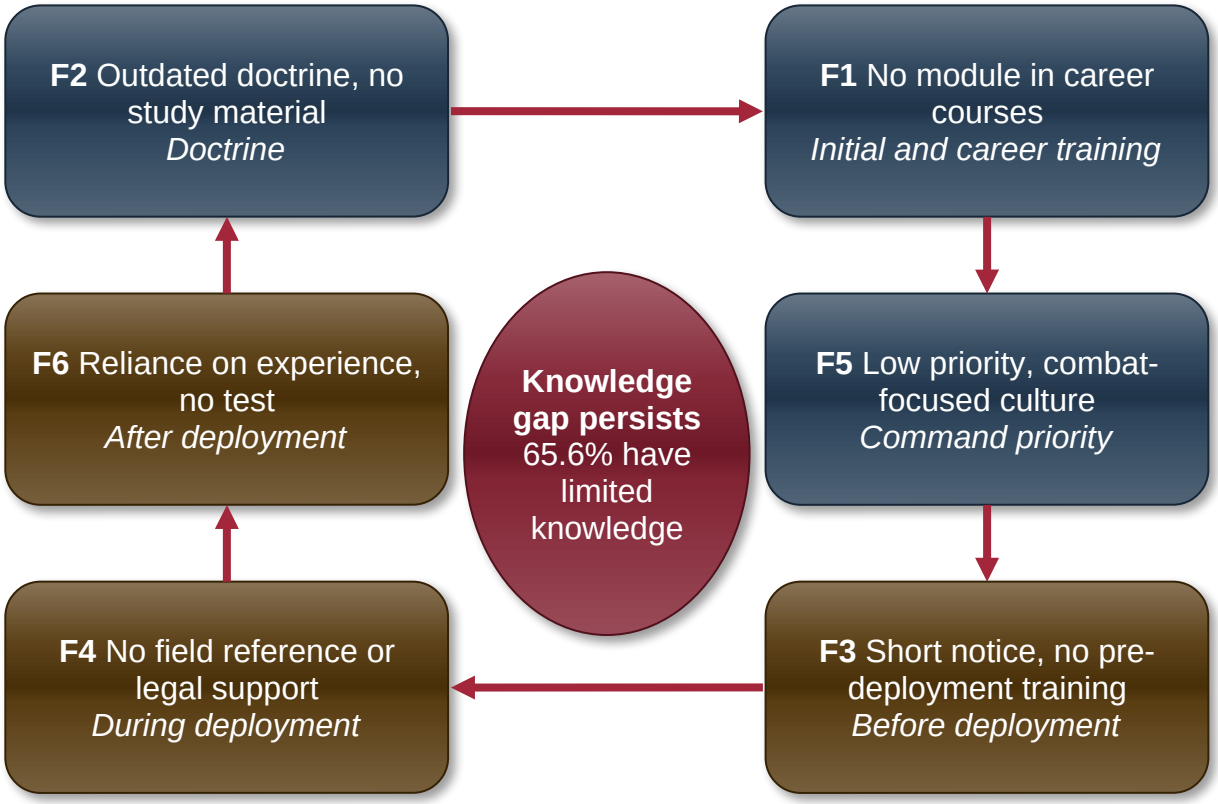
Cross-Impact Matrix of the Six Factors

Influence of (row) on (column)	F1	F2	F3	F4	F5	F6	Active sum	Role
F1 No module		1	2	1	**3**	2	**9**	**Driver**
F2 Outdated doctrine	**3**		1	**3**	1	1	**9**	**Driver**
F3 Short notice	0	0		1	1	2	**4**	**Result**
F4 No field support	0	0	0		0	**3**	**3**	**Result**
F5 Low priority	2	2	**3**	2		1	**10**	**Driver**
F6 No test	1	**3**	0	1	2		**7**	**Critical link**
Passive sum	**6**	**6**	**6**	**8**	**7**	**9**		

Note. Researcher's assessment: 0 = no influence, 1 = weak, 2 = moderate, 3 = strong. Active sum = influence exerted; passive sum = influence received.

Figure 4.2

The Cycle of Factors That Sustains the Knowledge Gap



Note. Researcher's own construct. Each factor of Table 4.1 is placed at the career stage where it acts.

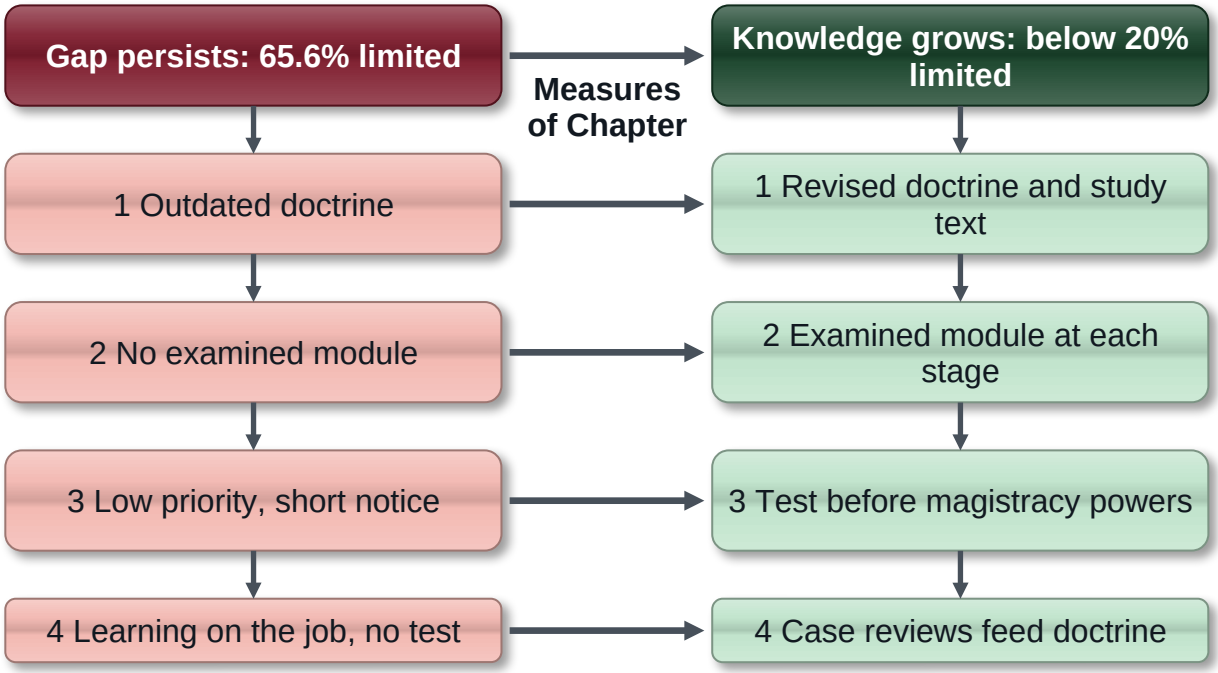
Analysis

The six factors explain the pattern found in Chapter III. Because no factor depends on the individual officer, the gap appears in every rank and every domain. Because the cycle has no test and no feedback, experience cannot break it, which is why majors and the most deployed officers know least.

Two factors carry the most weight. The absence of a module (F1) is the origin of the gap, and the absence of a test (F6) keeps it hidden. Breaking either one would weaken the whole cycle. Short-term measures such as briefings act only on F3, and the lower scores of trained officers show that such measures cannot work alone. A lasting remedy must act at several points of the cycle at once. This matches the practice of the comparable institutions in Table 2.4, which pair teaching with testing, and it sets the logic of the ways forward in Chapter V (Figure 4.3).

Figure 4.3

From Vicious to Virtuous Cycle



Note. Researcher's own construct from Figure 4.2 and Table 5.2. Nodes run in order from 1 to 4.

Summary of the Chapter

Chapter IV identified six institutional factors behind the knowledge gap: no module in career courses, outdated doctrine and no study material, short notice and no pre-deployment training, no field reference or legal support, low priority in a combat-focused culture, and reliance on experience without any test. Each factor is supported by the survey, a hard indicator and at least three of the four groups interviewed. The factors reinforce each other in a cycle that experience alone cannot break. The chapter answers the third secondary question.

Chapter V
Conclusions and Recommendations

General

The preceding chapters set a standard, measured the gap against it and traced its causes. This chapter answers the research questions and states where and how the hypothesis was proved. It then proposes ways forward that follow from the findings, draws the conclusion and makes recommendations. It ends with the scope for further research.

Answers to the Research Questions

Table 5.1 answers each research question from the evidence of the preceding chapters.

Table 5.1

Research Traceability Matrix

Research question	Key finding	Evidence	Factor	Recommendation
Primary: is knowledge adequate?	No; H0 rejected, H1 accepted	Table 3.5; Table 3.6	All	All (a to k)
1. What knowledge is required?	Six domains; standard 50% to 65%; doctrine 0% to 30%	Table 2.3; Figure 2.2	F2	f, a
2. What is the existing state?	39.3% of maximum; 65.6% limited; gap 11.2 to 25.0 points	Table 3.2, Table 3.4	F6	c, h
3. What factors affect the gap?	Six institutional factors in a cycle	Table 4.1; Table 4.2	F1 to F6	d, e, g, i, j, k
4. What measures are recommended?	Eleven measures; every factor covered	Table 5.2, Table 5.3	All	a to k

Note. Researcher's own construct. Recommendation letters are as in this chapter.

Proof of the Hypothesis

The hypothesis was tested in Chapter III against the decision rule set in Chapter I. Knowledge fell below the standard in all six domains, 65.6% of officers had limited knowledge, and officers with limited knowledge met each problem 32.3 to 36.4 points more often (z = 6.13 to 6.64, p < .001). All three conditions were met, so H0 was rejected and H1 accepted (Table 3.5). The result held without the uniform responders (Table B2), and the interviews and FGDs supported it (Table 3.7). Chapter II supplied the standard that made the test possible, and Chapter IV explained why the result occurred.

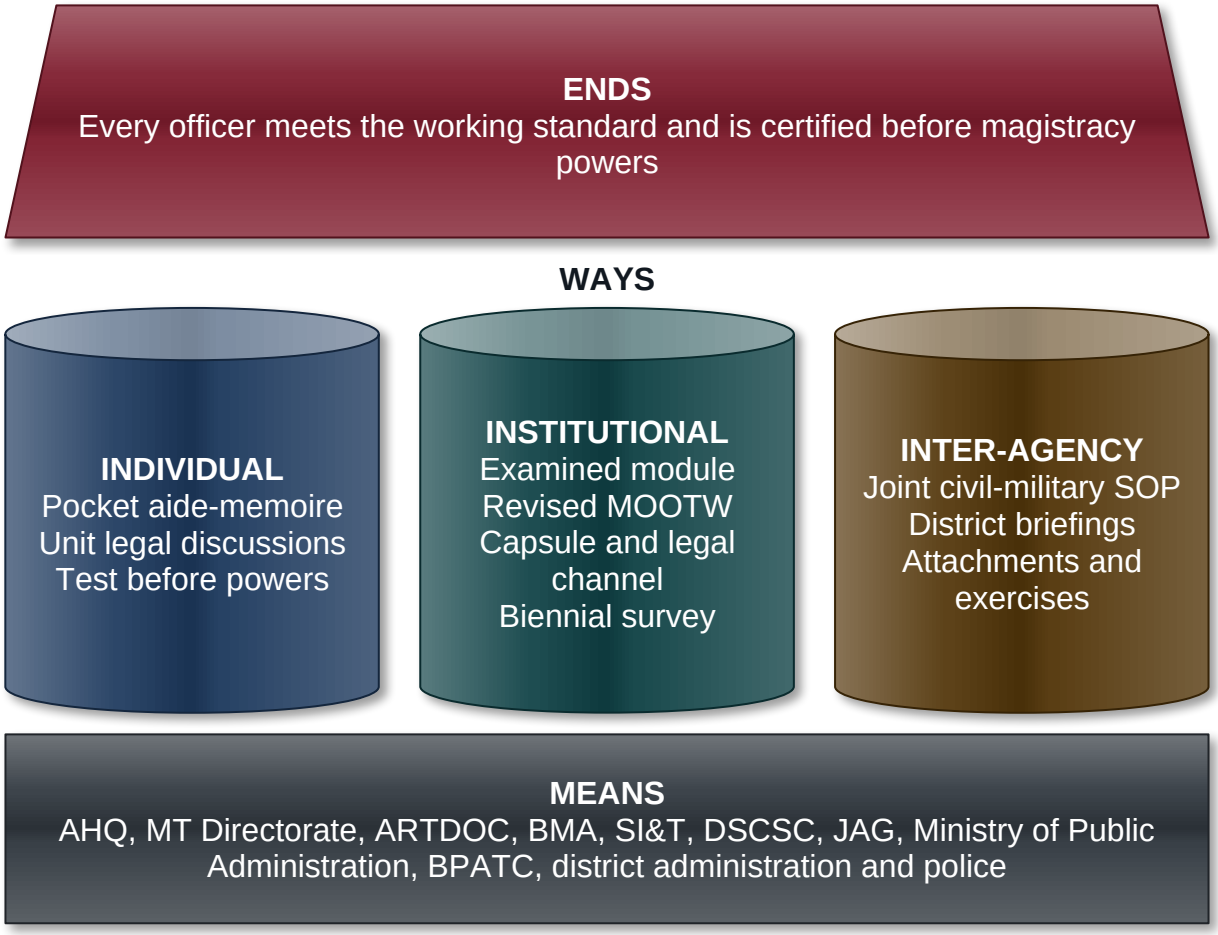
Ways Forward

Principles of the Ways Forward

The ways forward follow four principles drawn from the findings. First, knowledge must come before authority, as the theory (Chapter I) and comparable institutions (Table 2.4) require. Second, every measure must act on a factor identified in Chapter IV. Third, measures must use existing institutions and training cycles. Fourth, progress must be measured against the baseline set by this study (Figure 5.1).

Figure 5.1

Ends, Ways and Means of the Proposed Reform



Note. Researcher's own construct from Table 5.2 and the recommendations.

Lessons from Comparable Institutions

Learn before authority. Civil executive magistrates complete a 151-day law course, and police officers about a year of basic training, before they use such powers (Bangladesh Civil Service Administration Academy, n.d.; Rtv News, 2024). Army officers should likewise be taught and certified before magistracy powers are delegated, not after.

Keep rules short and binding. India's "Dos and Don'ts" for troops in internal security were upheld by its Supreme Court, which directed that they be followed strictly (*Naga People's Movement of Human Rights v. Union of India*, 1998). Its Army Headquarters later created a dedicated human rights section (Press Information Bureau, 2019). Short rules, backed by a responsible office, are easier to carry and to enforce in the field.

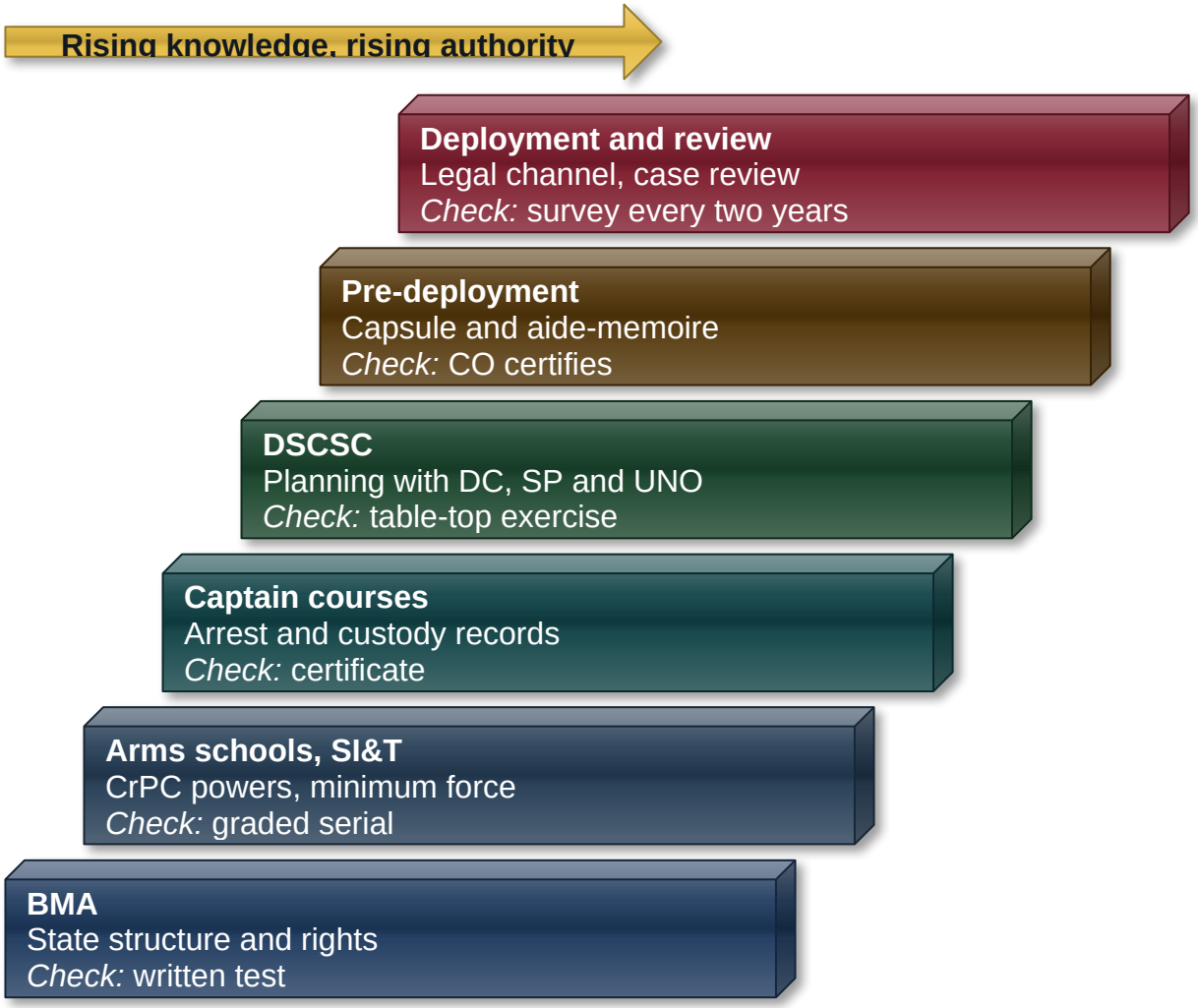
Teach in phases. The United States combines an online course with a short residential course (Kent, 2022). This suits the Army's busy training calendar, since officers can complete the first phase in their own time.

A Career-Long Knowledge Pathway

Figure 5.2 turns these lessons into a pathway. It runs from BMA through the arms and services schools and the School of Infantry and Tactics (SI&T), captain-level courses and DSCSC, to pre-deployment, deployment and review. Each stage adds one layer of knowledge and one check. Case reviews and a repeated survey feed back into doctrine, so that the cycle in Figure 4.2 is reversed.

Figure 5.2

Proposed Knowledge Pathway for Aid to Civil Administration Duties



Note. Researcher's own construct based on the findings of Chapters II to IV and the practice of comparable institutions (Table 2.4).

Proposed Measures

Table 5.2 lists eleven measures. Each measure is linked to the factor it breaks and to the finding it answers, and is grouped at one of three levels (Table 5.3; Figure 5.3).

Table 5.2

Proposed Measures, Factors Addressed, Findings, Support and Priority

Measure	Factors	Finding addressed	Support (%) or source	Priority
Individual level				
1. Pocket aide-memoire on aid to civil administration law and formats	F2, F4	57.2% least confident in documentation	Interviews; Indian practice	Immediate
2. Unit legal discussions and post-deployment case reviews	F5, F6	Experienced officers most often limited	71.1	Immediate
3. Test in magisterial procedure before magistracy powers	F6	63.6% limited on magistracy powers	Interviews	Immediate
Institutional level				
4. Formation-level legal advisory channel	F4	Brigade legal cell stretched	75.3	Immediate
5. Mandatory pre-deployment legal capsule	F3	74.2% say preparation time is not assured	75.0	Immediate

Measure	Factors	Finding addressed	Support (%) or source	Priority
6. Revised MOOTW with an aid to civil administration volume and study material	F2	Doctrine covers 0% to 30% of the standard	Doctrine review	Short term
7. Compulsory, examined module at every career stage	F1, F5	78.9% say courses cover the subject poorly or not at all	76.9	Short term
8. Repeat of this survey every two years	F6	No measure of knowledge existed before this study	Study design	Medium term
Inter-agency level				
9. District joint briefings to company level; liaison officers	F3, F4	Friction met often or always by 56.9%	Interviews	Immediate
10. Joint civil-military SOP for aid to civil administration	F2, F4	"Three police stations, three systems" (FGD)	Interviews	Short term
11. Orientation attachments and annual joint exercises	F1, F5	Coordination named least confident by 36.7%	76.1; 75.0	Medium term

Note. Support is the share of officers who agree or strongly agree (N = 360). Immediate = within 6 months; short term = within 18 months; medium term = within 3 years.

Table 5.3

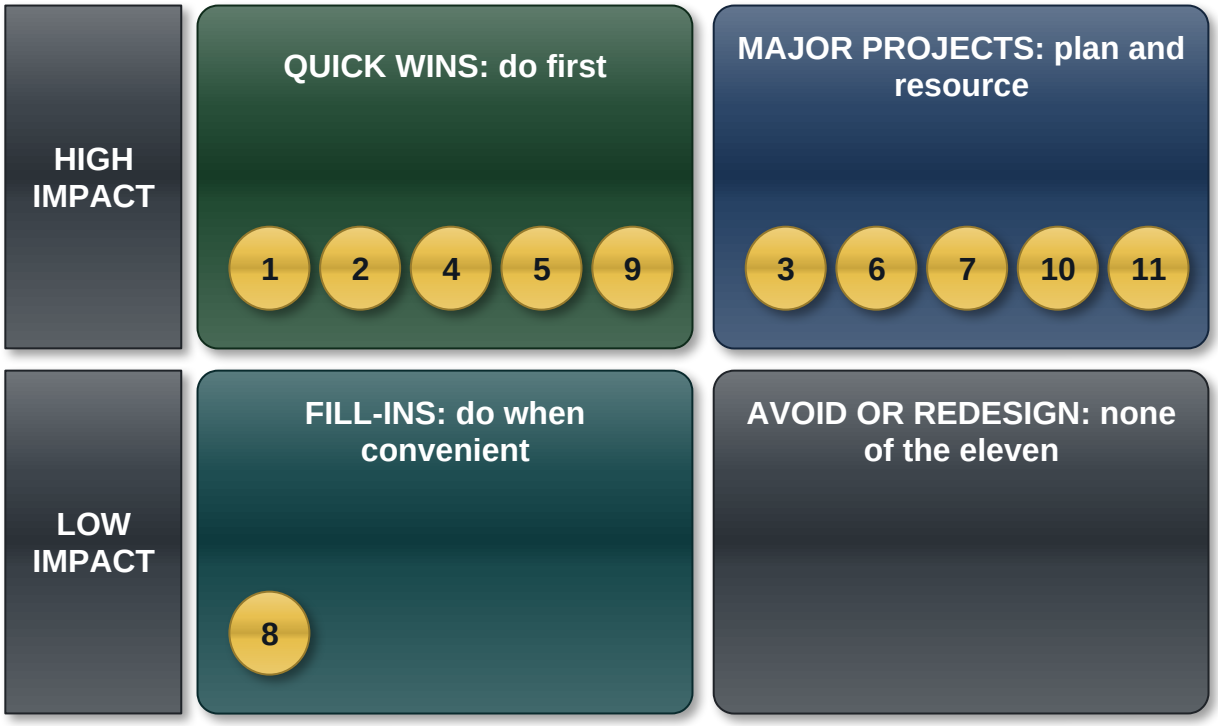
Factor and Measure Alignment Matrix

Measure	Level	F1	F2	F3	F4	F5	F6
1 Pocket aide-memoire	Individual		●		●		
2 Unit discussions, case reviews	Individual					●	●
3 Test before powers	Individual						●
4 Formation legal channel	Institutional				●		
5 Pre-deployment capsule	Institutional			●			
6 Revised MOOTW	Institutional		●				
7 Examined module	Institutional	●				●	
8 Biennial survey	Institutional						●
9 District joint briefings	Inter-agency			●	●		
10 Joint civil-military SOP	Inter-agency		●		●		
11 Attachments and exercises	Inter-agency	●				●	
Measures acting		**2**	**3**	**2**	**4**	**3**	**3**

Note. Based on Table 5.2. ● = the measure acts on the factor.

Figure 5.3

Impact and Effort Matrix of the Proposed Measures



Note. Researcher's assessment. Numbers refer to the measures in Table 5.2.

Individual Level

At the individual level, the officer takes responsibility for personal legal competence: the CrPC sections, arrest and seizure formats, custody time limits and the chain of requisition. Units should hold short legal discussions each week and review every case after deployment. A test in magisterial procedure should come before any future delegation. Interviewees in every group proposed some form of certification or assessment.

Institutional Level

At the institutional level, the Army must build knowledge through doctrine, training and support. The module should follow the pathway in Figure 5.2: state structure at BMA, procedure at SI&T and the arms and services schools, documentation and magistracy in captain-level courses, and planning at DSCSC. The Director of Military Training judged that a pilot at DSCSC could fit within the existing training calendar (Md. H. Kabir, personal communication, July 14, 2026).

Inter-Agency Level

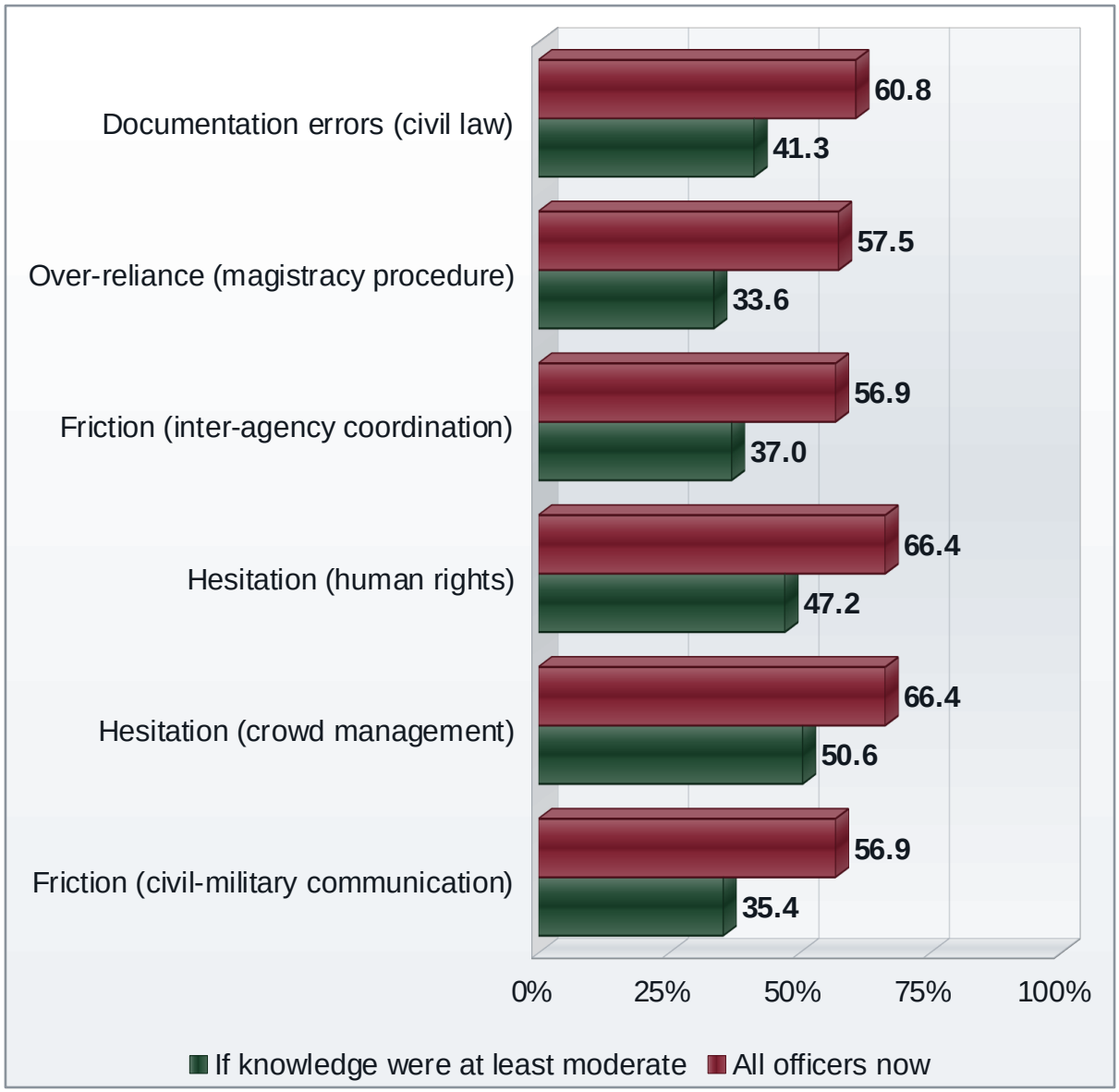
At the inter-agency level, the Army and civil agencies should learn to work together before a crisis. Joint briefings must reach company commanders and not stop at senior level. The DC and SP of Sylhet both recommended liaison arrangements, common SOPs and table-top exercises (Md. A. A. Mamun, personal communication, July 2026; R. Kabir, personal communication, July 2026). Lieutenant colonels support attachments and joint exercises most strongly, at 84.6% each.

Expected Benefit and Targets

The survey allows a simple estimate of the benefit. Suppose the measures raised every officer to at least the moderate level in each domain. The share meeting each problem often or always would then move towards the level already shown by officers with moderate or better knowledge (Figure 5.4). Documentation errors would fall from 60.8% to about 41%, over-reliance from 57.5% to about 34%, friction from 56.9% to between 35% and 37%, and hesitation from 66.4% to between 47% and 51%. The survey shows association rather than proof of cause, so these figures are indicative only.

Figure 5.4

Estimated Share of Officers Meeting Each Problem Often or Always if Knowledge Were at Least Moderate

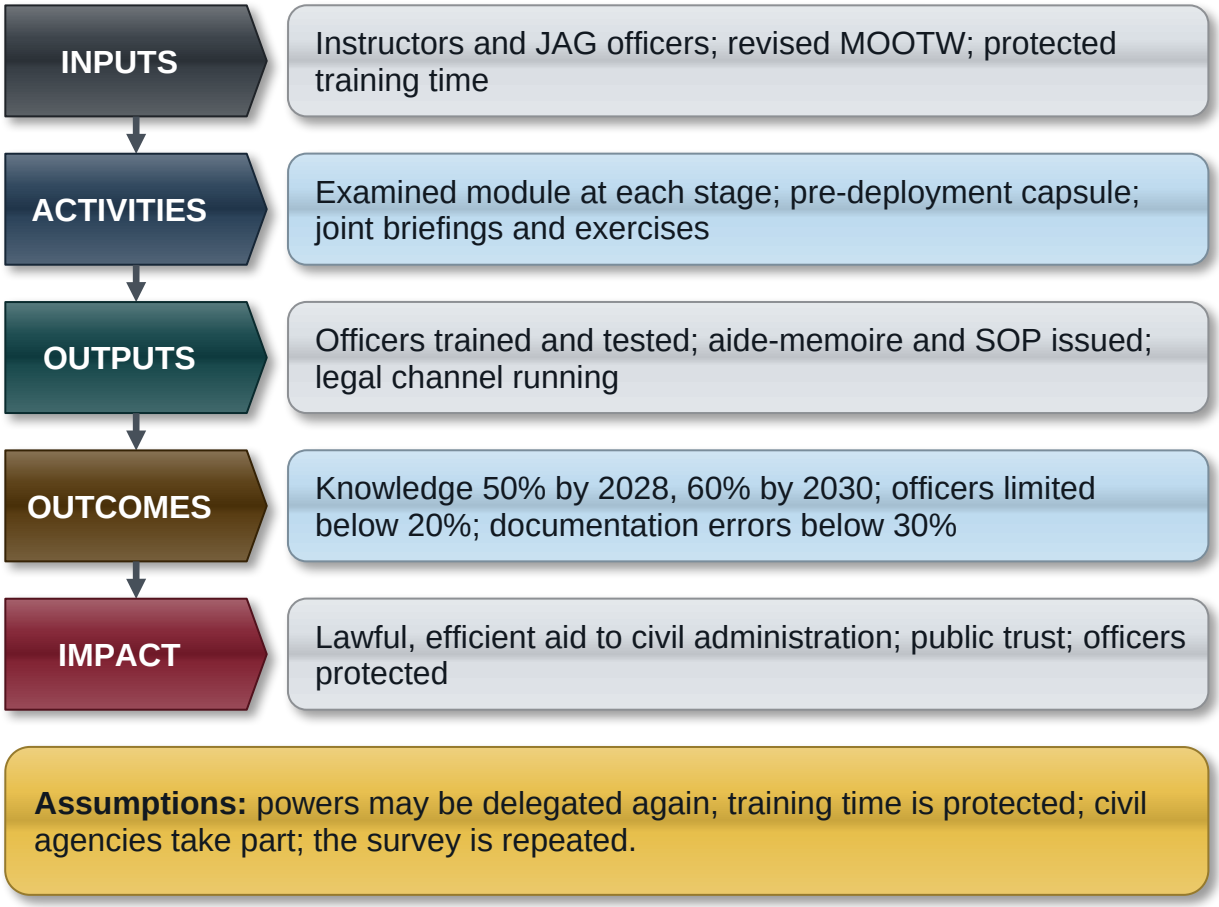


Note. N = 360. The estimate uses the share already reported by officers with at least moderate knowledge in the related domain.

Table 5.4 converts the baseline of this study into targets against which progress can be measured (Figure 5.5).

Figure 5.5

Theory of Change for Closing the Knowledge Gap



Note. Researcher's own construct from Table 5.2 and Table 5.4.

Table 5.4

Baseline and Proposed Targets for Measuring Progress

Indicator	Baseline (2026)	Target (2028 survey)	Target (2030 survey)
Knowledge, percentage of the scale maximum	39.3	50	60
Officers with limited knowledge (%)	65.6	Below 40	Below 20
Domains at or above the working standard	0 of 6	3 of 6	6 of 6
Officers who received institutional training (%)	30.3	60	100 of those liable for duty

Indicator	Baseline (2026)	Target (2028 survey)	Target (2030 survey)
Documentation errors often or always (%)	60.8	Below 45	Below 30
Hesitation often or always (%)	66.4	Below 50	Below 35
Officers certified before receiving magistracy powers (%)	0	100	100

Note. Researcher's own construct. Baselines are from Chapter III; targets for 2028 follow the estimate in Figure 5.4 and are proposals for validation.

Conclusion

This study asked whether the civil administration knowledge of Bangladesh Army officers is adequate for aid to civil administration duties. The answer is no. Measured against a standard drawn from law, practice and comparable institutions, officers' knowledge stands at 39.3% of the maximum, and every domain falls short. The gap does not close with rank, service or deployments. It is linked to more hesitation, documentation errors, over-reliance and friction on the ground, and the civil officials who worked alongside the troops saw the same faults.

The cause lies in the institution. Six factors, from the missing module to the missing test, sustain the gap in a cycle that no individual officer can break alone. The remedy, therefore, also lies in the institution. Civil magistrates and police officers are trained for months before they act (Bangladesh Civil Service Administration Academy, n.d.; Rtv News, 2024). Since September 2024, Army officers have carried a magistrate's powers; they now need a magistrate's preparation, delivered through a career-long pathway and confirmed by a test before authority. Every measure proposed fits within existing institutions. What is now required is a decision to act.

Recommendations

Based on the findings, the following recommendations are made; Table 5.5 shows their timeline.

Individual Level

a. The Military Training Directorate, with the Judge Advocate General's (JAG) department, may issue a pocket aide-memoire on aid to civil administration to every officer liable for such duty by March 2027.

b. Commanding officers may include a monthly legal discussion and a post-deployment case review in unit training with immediate effect.

c. Army Headquarters (AHQ), with the Ministry of Public Administration and the JAG department, may make a test in magisterial procedure a precondition for magistracy powers before any future delegation.

Institutional Level

d. The JAG department may establish a round-the-clock legal advisory channel at formation level by June 2027.

e. ARTDOC may introduce a mandatory pre-deployment legal capsule, with an online phase, for any future delegation by June 2027.

f. ARTDOC may revise the MOOTW series with a dedicated aid to civil administration volume and approved study material by December 2027.

g. The Military Training Directorate may task ARTDOC to design a compulsory, examined civil law and administration module along the pathway in Figure 5.2. The module may be piloted at SI&T and DSCSC by December 2027 and introduced at BMA and in all career courses by December 2028.

h. DSCSC may repeat the survey of this study every two years from 2028 and report progress against Table 5.4.

Inter-Agency Level

i. Formation headquarters, with district administrations and police, may hold joint briefings down to company commanders and appoint liaison officers before any future delegation.

j. AHQ, the Ministry of Public Administration and Bangladesh Police may issue a joint civil-military SOP for aid to civil administration by September 2027 and review it every year.

k. BMA and ARTDOC, with the Ministry of Public Administration, may introduce orientation attachments with district administrations and police stations. AHQ, with the Bangladesh Public Administration Training Centre

(BPATC), may conduct annual joint exercises. Both measures may start in January 2028.

Table 5.5

Implementation Roadmap of the Recommendations

Rec	Action	Q4 26	Q1 27	Q2 27	Q3 27	Q4 27	Q1 28	Q2 28	Q3 28	Q4 28
a	Pocket aide-memoire		Due							
b	Monthly legal discussion, case review									
c	Test before magistracy powers			Due						
d	Formation legal advisory channel			Due						
e	Pre-deployment legal capsule			Due						
f	Revised MOOTW volume					Due				
g	Examined module: design, pilot, all courses					Due				Due
h	Repeat survey every two years								Due	
i	District briefings, liaison officers									
j	Joint civil-military SOP				Due					
k	Attachments and joint exercises									

Note. Based on the recommendations above. Navy = individual level; teal = institutional; green = inter-agency. Due = completion date stated in the recommendation.

Scope for Further Research

a. A tested, scenario-based assessment could replace self-assessment and give a more exact measure of the gap.
b. The same question could be asked of junior commissioned officers and non-commissioned officers, who do much of the work on the ground.
c. The first officers trained under the proposed module could be measured against the baseline of this study.
d. A comparison with the Navy and the Air Force, whose officers received the same powers, would show whether the pattern holds across the armed forces.

_____

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Major
Course Participant
Course Number 02

Mirpur Cantonment
30 September 2026

Annexures:

A. Survey Instrument.
B. Calculations and Data Checks.
C. Legal Basis.
D. Summary of Interviews.
E. Summary of Focus Group Discussions.

Distribution:
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Annexure A
Survey Instrument

The survey was administered through Google Forms from 17 to 31 July 2026 to officers up to the rank of lieutenant colonel with experience of aid to civil administration. The form used the Army's term, aid to civil power (ACP). The questions are listed below as worded in the form, grouped by topic, with the response options in scale order. Items on which officers could select more than one option are marked. Service numbers and names were recorded only to detect duplicate submissions and were not analysed.

Profile

1. Rank [Lt; Capt; Maj; Lt Col].
2. Length of service [0 to 8 years; 8 to 15 years; 15 to 20 years; above 20 years].
3. Number of times employed in ACP duties [1 to 3 times; 3 to 5 times; more than 5 times].
4. Have you ever worked with any representative of civil administration jointly? [Yes; No; Maybe].
5. Types of ACP duties performed [open answer].

Knowledge

Stem: "Please rate your current level of knowledge in each area" [very limited; limited; moderate; adequate; high; very high].

6. Specific legal powers and limitations delegated to you as a Special Executive Magistrate.
7. Correct legal procedures for arrest, property seizure and documentation.
8. Organisation, role, structure and functions of the district and upazila civil administration (DC/UNO).
9. Legal preconditions and escalation sequence for dispersing an unlawful assembly (Section 141 of the Penal Code, 1860).
10. Legal and constitutional safeguards governing arrest, detention and custody.
11. Accepted principles on the use of force (necessity and proportionality).

12. Special procedural requirements for handling women, juveniles and vulnerable persons.
13. Scope and limitations of Special Executive Magistracy powers delegated to Army officers.
14. Graduated escalation and de-escalation measures with police and magistrates.

Perception of the Gap

15. Did you ever feel hesitant in taking decisions due to inadequate knowledge while deployed in ACP duties? [Yes; No; Maybe].
16. Does a significant knowledge gap exist among officers about civil administration and legal procedures? [highly significant; moderate; no, knowledge is adequate; unsure].
17. On which topic do officers feel least confident? (more than one) [applying SEM powers within legal limits; documentation for arrests, searches and evidence handover; coordination with DC, UNO and police; legal thresholds for crowd dispersal and use of force].
18. Are officers given adequate time to prepare legally and administratively before ACP tasks? [yes; sometimes; no, deployments are too sudden].
19. What is the most significant operational challenge caused by the gap? (more than one) [hesitation or delay; procedural errors in documentation; friction with police and civil administration; risk of legal overreach or rights violations].

Operational Effects

Stem: "Please indicate how frequently you have observed the following" [never; rarely; sometimes; often; always].

20. Hesitation, dilemma or delay in decision making due to uncertainty over legal boundaries.
21. Procedural errors in documentation, such as faulty arrest memos or seizure lists.
22. Jurisdictional friction or miscommunication with the civil administration over primary authority.
23. Over-reliance on civilian magistrates or police because officers lacked confidence in legal procedures.

Causes, Training and Importance

24. Causes of the gap [strongly disagree; disagree; neutral; agree; strongly agree]: no civil law and administration module in career courses; no mandatory pre-deployment training capsule; no field reference material (SOPs or handbooks); differing views of senior leadership; no precise or customised study material.
25. Training: institutional training received [yes; no; maybe]; adequacy of foundational career courses [not at all to very well]; emphasis of the training culture on civil administration [not at all to a large extent].
26. Importance of each of the six knowledge domains [not important; slightly important; moderately important; important; very important].

Measures

27. Should the Army take steps to bridge the gap? [yes; no; maybe].
28. Support for six measures [strongly disagree to strongly agree]: a compulsory civil law and administration module at BMA, arms and services schools or SI&T; an orientation attachment with the civil administration; mandatory pre-deployment training before SEM powers; regular joint exercises with BPATC; unit-level training to build a culture of learning; a legal advisory hotline.
29. Importance of a formal civil administration framework [not important to very important].

Two defects in the form were handled as follows. The middle option of the measures scale was printed as "Neutran" and was coded as neutral. The item on the need for institutional training carried an unlabelled option, "Option 1", chosen by 42 officers, and was therefore not analysed.

Annexure B
Calculations and Data Checks

Responses were exported from Google Forms to Microsoft Excel. Of 362 records, two from the same officer were removed: an abandoned partial submission and an earlier complete submission replaced by the officer's final answer. Knowledge answers were coded from very limited (1) to very high (6), and frequency, agreement and importance answers from 1 to 5. Table B1 shows how each figure in the paper was calculated.

Table B1

Calculations with Worked Examples from the Survey

Figure	Calculation	Worked example
Percentage	Number giving an answer ÷ number answering × 100	229 of 360 officers rated SEM powers limited or very limited: 229 ÷ 360 × 100 = 63.6%
Mean score	Sum of coded answers ÷ number of answers	SEM powers: 799 ÷ 360 = 2.22, in the limited band
Percentage of maximum	Mean ÷ highest possible score × 100	All nine questions: 2.36 ÷ 6 × 100 = 39.3%
Domain score	Average of the domain's questions	Civil law: (2.28 + 2.33) ÷ 2 = 2.30, or 38.4% of the maximum
Gap	Working standard (%) minus existing knowledge (%)	Civil law: 55 - 38.4 = 16.6 percentage points
Officer's knowledge level	Average of the officer's nine answers, read against Table 1.5	Answers 3, 3, 3, 2, 3, 2, 2, 2, 3: 23 ÷ 9 = 2.56, limited
Difference between groups	Percentage in one group minus percentage in the other	Documentation errors: 72.9 - 37.9 = 35.0 points
Two-proportion z-test	$z = (p_1 - p_2) \div \sqrt{[p(1 - p)(1/n_1 + 1/n_2)]}$, where p is the pooled proportion	Documentation errors: (0.729 - 0.379) ÷ 0.054 = 6.47, $p < .001$

Figure	Calculation	Worked example
Sample size	$n_0 = z^2 \times p(1 - p) \div e^2$; $n = n_0 \div [1 + (n_0 - 1) \div N]$	$1.96^2 \times 0.5 \times 0.5 \div 0.05^2 = 384$; for N = 1,000: 384 ÷ 1.383 = 278
Margin of error	$e = z \times \sqrt{[p(1 - p) \div n]} \times \sqrt{[(N - n) \div (N - 1)]}$	For n = 360: 1.96 × 0.0264 × 0.800 = 0.041, that is 4.1%

Note. z = 1.96 for 95% confidence; p = 0.5, the most cautious assumption; e = 0.05; N = estimated population. In the z-test, n_1 = 236 (limited) and n_2 = 124 (moderate or better).

Four checks were applied. Every record has complete answers to the knowledge and effect questions; all 10,799 coded answers matched the original text; the sample of 360 exceeds the 278 required; and the main results were recalculated without the 80 officers who gave the same answer to all nine knowledge questions (Table B2).

Table B2

Main Results with and Without the 80 Uniform Responders

Result	All officers (n = 360)	Without uniform responders (n = 280)
Knowledge, percentage of maximum	39.3	38.9
Officers with limited knowledge (%)	65.6	70.4
Difference in hesitation (points)	32.3	20.4
Difference in documentation errors (points)	35.0	26.0
Difference in over-reliance (points)	33.6	25.0
Difference in friction (points)	36.4	26.7

Note. Differences compare officers with limited knowledge and those with moderate or better knowledge. Every difference remains above the 10-point threshold of the decision rule.

Annexure C
Legal Basis

This annexure gives the official heading and effect of the provisions summarised in Table 2.3. Headings are taken from the Laws of Bangladesh portal (bdlaws.minlaw.gov.bd), accessed on 26 September 2026. The 17 conferred sections were confirmed from press reports of the notification (The Business Standard, 2024a; The Daily Star, 2024a, 2024c), since the gazette itself was not available.

Table C1

Code of Criminal Procedure, 1898: Sections Relevant to Army Officers in Aid to Civil Administration

Section	Official heading	Effect	Status
12(1)	Special Magistrate	Government may give any person all or any powers of an Executive Magistrate; basis of SEM appointment	Enabling
17(1)	Subordination of Executive, Judicial and Metropolitan Magistrates	Executive Magistrates under ss. 10 and 12(1) are subordinate to the District Magistrate, who allocates their work	Enabling
64	Offence committed in Magistrate's presence	Magistrate may arrest, or order the arrest of, an offender in the magistrate's presence	Conferred
65	Arrest by or in presence of Magistrate	Magistrate may arrest, or direct the arrest in the magistrate's presence of, a person for whom a warrant could be issued	Conferred

Section	Official heading	Effect	Status
83	Warrant forwarded for execution outside jurisdiction	Receiving Executive Magistrate endorses the warrant and has it executed	Conferred
84	Warrant directed to police-officer for execution outside jurisdiction	Police officer takes the warrant to an Executive Magistrate for endorsement	Conferred
86	Procedure by Magistrate before whom person arrested is brought	Magistrate checks identity and sends the person to the issuing court	Conferred
95(2)	Procedure as to letters and telegrams	Magistrate may require postal authorities to search for and hold an item needed for a case	Conferred
100	Search for persons wrongfully confined	Magistrate may issue a search warrant to find a person wrongfully confined	Conferred
105	Magistrate may direct search in his presence	Search of a place in the magistrate's presence	Conferred
107	Security for keeping the peace in other cases	Bond to keep the peace for up to one year from a person likely to breach it	Conferred
109	Security for good behaviour from vagrants and suspected persons	Bond for good behaviour for up to one year	Conferred
110	Security for good behaviour from habitual offenders	Bond for good behaviour for up to three years	Conferred
126	Discharge of sureties	Release of a surety and demand for fresh security	Conferred

Section	Official heading	Effect	Status
127	Assembly to disperse on command of Magistrate or police officer	Command to an unlawful assembly, or assembly of five or more likely to disturb the peace, to disperse	Conferred
128	Use of civil force to disperse	Dispersal by civil force and arrest of those who refuse	Conferred
129	Use of military force	Executive Magistrate of highest rank present may have an assembly dispersed by military force	Not conferred
130	Duty of officer commanding troops required by Magistrate to disperse assembly	Officer must obey and use as little force and cause as little injury as possible	Conferred
131	Power of commissioned military officers to disperse assembly	Officer may act when no magistrate can be contacted, then follow the magistrate	Not conferred
132	Protection against prosecution for acts done under this Chapter	No prosecution without government sanction for acts done in good faith	Applies
133	Conditional order for removal of nuisance	Conditional order to remove a public nuisance or show cause	Conferred
142	Injunction pending inquiry	Immediate order to prevent imminent danger while a nuisance case is pending	Conferred

Note. Enabling = basis of the appointment; conferred = listed in the notification of 17 September 2024; not conferred = not listed; applies = applies to troops by law.

Table C2

Safeguards Binding Any Officer Who Arrests, Searches or Detains

Provision	Duty or limit
Constitution Art. 33	Person arrested to be told the grounds, allowed a lawyer and produced before a magistrate within 24 hours
Constitution Art. 35(5)	No torture or cruel, inhuman or degrading punishment or treatment
CrPC s. 46A (inserted by amendment)	Person making the arrest shows identity, prepares an arrest memo, informs the family within 24 hours and allows a lawyer
CrPC ss. 46D, 46E	Custodian cares for health; medical examination soon after arrest, by a female doctor for a woman where practicable
CrPC s. 50	No more restraint than necessary to prevent escape
CrPC s. 52	A woman is searched only by another woman, with strict regard to decency
CrPC s. 103	Search in presence of two respectable local witnesses; list of seized items signed by them
CrPC ss. 61, 167	No detention beyond 24 hours without a magistrate's order; police custody (remand) only on the order of a Judicial Magistrate
Evidence Act ss. 24 to 26	Confessions obtained by inducement or made in police custody are not admissible
Penal Code ss. 220, 330, 342	Offences of wrongful confinement by a person in authority, hurt to extort confession, and wrongful confinement
Torture and Custodial Death (Prevention) Act, 2013	Torture and custodial death are criminal offences of the custodian

Provision	Duty or limit
Children Act, 2013 ss. 44, 45	No arrest below 9 years; no handcuff or rope; parents and probation officer informed
Appellate Division guidelines (2016)	Force only when strictly necessary; arrest memo; relative informed within 12 hours; female constable present when a woman is arrested

Note. Based on the instruments listed and *Bangladesh v. Bangladesh Legal Aid and Services Trust* (2016). The application of police-specific sections to an Army officer is by inference, since such an officer normally hands the arrested person to the police or a magistrate.

Table C3

History of the Magistracy Notifications, 2024 to 2026

Date	Notification
17 Sep 2024	Commissioned Army officers appointed Special Executive Magistrates nationwide for 60 days under CrPC ss. 12(1) and 17, for the 17 listed provisions
End Sep 2024	Same powers extended to commissioned officers of the Navy and Air Force
Nov 2024 to Sep 2025	Six extensions of 60 days each; from November 2024, limited to officers of captain rank or equivalent and above, including Army officers deputed to the Coast Guard and Border Guard Bangladesh
11 Nov 2025	Extended from 12 November 2025 to 28 February 2026, covering the national election
After 28 Feb 2026	No further nationwide extension found
22 Jun 2026	Army officers of captain rank and above appointed for 22 to 30 June 2026 in the Dhaka, Chattogram and Gazipur metropolitan areas and the Narayanganj, Gopalganj and Faridpur districts

Note. Based on The Business Standard (2024a), bdnews24.com (2024), The Daily Star (2025), Dhaka Tribune (2026) and The Financial Express (2026). The gazette notifications were not retrieved, and the exact date of the Navy and Air Force notification is unconfirmed.

Annexure D

Summary of Interviews

Six senior commanders and directors were interviewed on 14 July 2026, and the DC and the SP of Sylhet in July 2026. Semi-structured questions covered the knowledge gap, the September 2024 delegation, joint training and the stage of a career at which the knowledge should be taught. Respondents consented to attribution. Table D1 summarises the main points of each interview.

Table D1

Main Observations and Recommendations of the Interviewees

Respondent	Main observations	Main recommendations
Chief of General Staff, Lt Gen Md Mainur Rahman	Lack of orientation causes friction and minor delays; units may overstep limits or underuse the civil administration; powers without legal training led to overcaution and coordination gaps	Joint modules and exercises in the annual training cycle; state structure at BMA and field legal powers in basic and junior staff courses
Director of Infantry, Brig Gen M. M. H. Chowdhury	Companies arrive tactically ready but administratively blank; commanders unsure when dispersal is lawful; neighbouring companies read their powers differently; arrest papers not always as the law requires	Civil-military package in battalion collective training; teaching tied to the infantry career from BMA to NDC; documentation taught at company-commander level
Director of Military Training, Brig Gen Md Humayun Kabir	Training-to-task mismatch; officers unsure of limits on remand, summons and penalties; case diaries and evidence recording new to them; briefings alone are not enough	Certification before any future delegation; pilot at DSCSC in 2027; phased modules from BMA to NDC; a joint civil-military training cell

Respondent	Main observations	Main recommendations
Director of Military Operations, Brig Gen Dewan Mohammad Monzur Hossain	Gap seen in after-action reports; delayed authorisation, fragmented intelligence and stalled logistics; jurisdictional disputes after September 2024	Operational-legal certification first; division-level joint command post exercises; a pocket handbook for field commanders
Commander, 52 Infantry Brigade, Brig Gen Siafur Rahman	Commanders unsure whether a requirement goes to the DC or the SP; errors in detention records; small legal cell stretched thin; certification must come before delegation	Quarterly table-top and annual field exercises with civil agencies; reciprocal attachments; a brigade coordination cell with legal reference cards
Commander, Para Commando Brigade, Brig Gen MM Imrul Hasan	Specialised tasks carry the highest legal exposure: inadmissible evidence, challenged use of force and reputational damage	Legal module in commando courses; orientation with police special units; annual joint certification exercise; standing legal advice
DC and District Magistrate, Sylhet, Md. Abdullah Al Mamun	Preparedness rated 5 out of 10; superficial grasp of magisterial procedure and evidence; searches without warrants, detentions beyond limits and force without de-escalation; Sylhet detentions overturned and High Court scrutiny ordered	Handbook on aid to civil administration; pre-deployment orientation; district liaison cells; embedded legal advisers; common SOPs; joint table-top exercises; certification as a career requirement

Respondent	Main observations	Main recommendations
SP, Sylhet, Reazul Kabir	Rated 8 to 9 out of 10 for tactical tasks but 4 to 5 for civil functions; arrests without grounds documented; no chain of custody; female detainees without female custody staff; briefings not passed to company level	Pre-deployment legal orientation; round-the-clock legal advice; joint operations centres; annually updated joint SOPs; attachments to police stations

Note. In the text, interviews are cited as personal communications and are not listed in the references, in line with APA 7. NDC = National Defence College.

The eight interviews agree that the gap is real and visible on the ground, that the September 2024 powers were exercised sincerely but without enough legal preparation, and that joint training with the civil administration is both necessary and feasible within existing training cycles. They differ mainly in emphasis, from institutional reputation at Army Headquarters to legal exposure in specialised units and judicial accountability on the civil side.

Annexure E

Summary of Focus Group Discussions

Two FGDs were moderated by the researcher. The first was held at DSCSC on 20 July 2026 with four junior officers: Capt Abdullah Al Islam, Capt Kazi Farhan Sharif, Capt Md Akib Arshad Ouikko and Lt Tahmid Jaman. The second was held at an East Bengal battalion headquarters on 22 July 2026 with the battalion command group: Lt Col Md Shafiqul Islam (commanding officer), Maj M Hasan Al Mahmud (second-in-command), Maj Sk Md Muzahidul Islam and Maj Nur Muhamad Abu Jobayeer (company commanders) and Maj Md Mahfuzur Rahman (adjutant). Table E1 compares the main themes.

Table E1

Main Themes of the Two Focus Group Discussions

Theme	Junior officers (20 July 2026)	Battalion command group (22 July 2026)
How knowledge is gained	From NCOs, adjutants and a summary circulated on WhatsApp ("that PDF was our training")	From the commanding officer's own briefings and the adjutant's own formats, which leave the unit on posting
September 2024 powers	Uncertainty over authority when signing remand papers; police also unbriefed	Judicial power exercised after about two hours of lecture; outcome described as "luck, not design"
Coordination	Did not know the UNO on a first deployment; a young officer "either goes too soft or too hard"	Three police stations followed three systems; the first 72 hours of a deployment spent on orientation
Joint training	Short attachments to the DC office and police station; scenario-based, not ceremonial	Light, regular and reciprocal; coordination to be graded as well as tactics

Theme	Junior officers (20 July 2026)	Battalion command group (22 July 2026)
Where to teach	Basics at BMA; a graded serial at SI&T; unit refresher before standby; documentation as an assessed subject	Awareness at BMA; SI&T with magistrate role-players; DSCSC as the main fixing point; documentation taught with coordination

Note. NCO = non-commissioned officer. Quotations are from the FGD records.

Both groups confirmed that the gap is bridged by individual initiative rather than by the institution, and both raised documentation skills unprompted.